Prepositions
Diagnostic Assessment

200 Questions • Mastery Level
Reasoning, misconceptions and meaning-change

Name: _____

Class: _____

Date: _____

Instructions for the Student

- Read every sentence carefully before you answer. Many questions look simple but hide a subtle trap, so slow down and think about the exact meaning.
- For multiple-choice questions, write the letter (a, b, c or d) of the best answer on the answer line. Some questions ask you to **choose ALL** that apply - read the instruction each time.
- For questions that ask you to correct, explain, compare or rewrite, write your full answer on the ruled lines provided. Always give your reason, not just the fixed word.
- Some sentences are already correct. Do not change a sentence just because you are asked to check it - if it is right, say so.
- Where two options are both acceptable, the question will tell you; be ready to explain the difference in meaning rather than pick one blindly.
- Do not use a dictionary, the internet or any help. This is a diagnostic test: it is meant to reveal exactly what you understand and where your gaps are, so your honest answers are the most useful.
- Attempt every question. If you are unsure, make your best reasoned choice - a thoughtful wrong answer tells us more than a blank.
- The complete **Answer Key and Reasoning** is printed at the very end. Do not look at it until you have finished.

Assessment Overview

This assessment contains 200 questions arranged in nine sections. It moves well beyond simple recall: the questions probe how you reason about prepositions - the misconceptions, overgeneralisations and calques (word-for-word translations) that trip up even strong students, and the way a single preposition can change the meaning of a sentence. Difficulty ranges from moderate to very hard.

The sections are:

- **Section A - Prepositions of Time** (Questions 1–24, 24 questions)
- **Section B - Place and Position** (Questions 25–45, 21 questions)
- **Section C - Movement and Direction** (Questions 46–67, 22 questions)
- **Section D - Verbs and Their Prepositions** (Questions 68–93, 26 questions)
- **Section E - Adjectives and Their Prepositions** (Questions 94–115, 22 questions)
- **Section F - Unnecessary, Wrong, Missing or Correct** (Questions 116–139, 24 questions)
- **Section G - Prepositional Phrases** (Questions 140–160, 21 questions)
- **Section H - Meaning Change Through Preposition Choice** (Questions 161–181, 21 questions)
- **Section I - Abstract and Non-Physical Prepositions** (Questions 182–200, 19 questions)

Write your answers in the spaces provided. When you have finished, check your work against the Answer Key and Reasoning at the end, which explains not only the correct answer but why each wrong option is tempting, the grammar principle involved, and an easy way to remember it.

Assessment Questions

Section A - Prepositions of Time

Multiple choice

1. The training programme lasts ___ six weeks, and it should be finished ___ the middle of March.

(a) for ... by
(b) since ... until
(c) during ... by
(d) for ... until

Answer:

Multiple choice

2. Guests may stay in the hall ___ ten o'clock, but the doors must be locked ___ then.

(a) until ... by
(b) by ... until
(c) for ... by
(d) until ... until

Answer:

Multiple choice

3. Assembly starts ___ 8:15 ___ Monday morning, right ___ the start of the new term.

(a) at ... on ... at
(b) on ... at ... in
(c) at ... in ... on
(d) in ... on ... at

Answer:

Multiple choice

4. Our science teacher has guided this club ___ 2021, so she has led it ___ about five years.

(a) since ... for
(b) for ... since
(c) from ... for
(d) since ... from

Answer:

Multiple choice

5. The 9:00 train left exactly ___; fortunately we arrived ___ to jump aboard.

(a) on time ... in time
(b) in time ... on time
(c) on time ... on time
(d) in time ... in time

Answer:

_____

Explain the difference

6. Explain the difference in meaning between: (i) 'The report will be ready in an hour.' (ii) 'The report will be ready within an hour.'

_____

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

7. The rehearsals were messy, but ___ the play was a hit; the cast bowed ___ the last scene.

(a) in the end ... at the end
(b) at the end ... in the end
(c) in the end ... in the end
(d) at the end ... at the end

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

8. You should reach the exam hall ___ the bell rings; aim to be seated ___ 9:30 at the latest.

(a) before ... by
(b) by ... before
(c) until ... by
(d) before ... until

Answer:

_____

Fill in the blank

9. My grandfather has collected stamps ___ 1998.

_____

_____

Multiple choice

10. ___ the thunderstorm the lights flickered, and the power stayed off ___ two hours.

(a) During ... for
(b) For ... during
(c) Since ... for
(d) During ... since

Answer:

_____

Sentence correction

11. Correct the preposition error: 'She has been living in Pune since three years.'

_____

_____

_____

Are both acceptable?

12. In the sentence 'We stayed with our cousins ___ the summer holidays', are both 'over' and 'during' acceptable? Justify briefly.

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

13. We reached the campsite ___ night and set off again ___ dawn.

(a) at ... at
(b) in ... at
(c) at ... in
(d) in ... in

Answer:

_____

Rewrite (keep the meaning)

14. Rewrite using 'by': 'You must return the equipment no later than Friday.'

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

15. The shop is busiest ___ 12 ___ 2 in the afternoon.

(a) between ... and
(b) from ... and
(c) between ... to
(d) since ... to

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

16. Don't worry - the results will be announced ___ a few days.

(a) in
(b) since
(c) for
(d) by

Answer:

_____

Explain the difference

17. Explain why 'I will wait for you until 6' is correct but 'I will wait for you by 6' is not.

_____

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

18. India became a republic ___ 26 January ___ 1950.

(a) on ... in
(b) in ... on
(c) at ... in
(d) on ... at

Answer:

_____

Dialogue completion

19. Complete B's reply with the correct time prepositions. A: When is the school trip? B: It's ___ the 14th, and we'll be away ___ three days.

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

20. The mangoes ripen ___ summer, usually ___ May or June.

(a) in ... in
(b) at ... on
(c) on ... in
(d) in ... on

Answer:

_____

Compare the two sentences

21. Which is correct and why is the other wrong: (i) 'I finished the essay in two hours.' (ii) 'I finished the essay for two hours.'

_____

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

22. ___ the age of ten she had already written a novel; she published it ___ 2020.

(a) At ... in
(b) In ... on
(c) On ... in
(d) At ... on

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

23. He hasn't spoken to me ___ we quarrelled, which is now ___ almost a month.

(a) since ... for
(b) for ... since
(c) from ... for
(d) since ... from

Answer:

_____

Sentence correction

24. Correct the time prepositions: 'The meeting is scheduled at Tuesday in 3 p.m.'

_____

_____

_____

Section B - Place and Position

Multiple choice

25. She waited ___ the bus stop, ___ front of the bakery.

(a) at ... in
(b) in ... in
(c) at ... on
(d) on ... in

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

26. We arrived ___ the cinema early and found our seats ___ row H.

(a) at ... in
(b) in ... at
(c) at ... on
(d) in ... in

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

27. She gently pulled a blanket ___ the sleeping baby.

(a) over
(b) above
(c) on top
(d) upon

Answer:

_____

Compare the two sentences

28. Explain the difference: (i) 'The helicopter hovered above the stadium.' (ii) 'The helicopter flew over the stadium.'

_____

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

29. By midnight the temperature had dropped ___ zero, and it stayed ___ freezing all night.

(a) below ... below
(b) under ... under
(c) below ... under
(d) under ... below

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

30. ___ his textbooks, he keeps a dictionary ___ his desk.

(a) Besides ... beside
(b) Beside ... besides
(c) Besides ... besides
(d) Beside ... beside

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

31. The secret was shared ___ the three founders and never spread ___ the wider staff.

(a) between ... among
(b) among ... between
(c) between ... between
(d) among ... among

Answer:

_____

Explain the error in the rule

32. A student says, 'between can only be used for two things.' Give one correct sentence that shows this rule is too simple, and explain.

_____

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

33. He isn't ___ home right now; he's still ___ work.

(a) at ... at
(b) in ... at
(c) at ... in
(d) in ... in

Answer:

Multiple choice

34. The bakery is ___ the library - you see it right across the road as you leave the library steps.

(a) opposite
(b) in front of
(c) before
(d) beside

Answer:

Compare the two sentences

35. Explain the difference: (i) 'The taxi stopped in front of the hotel.' (ii) 'The taxi stopped opposite the hotel.'

Multiple choice

36. The manager is ___ the office today, so email her instead; her assistant is waiting ___ the meeting room for you.

(a) out of ... outside
(b) outside ... out of
(c) out of ... out of
(d) outside ... outside

Answer:

Multiple choice

37. There's a decent chemist ___ the station, roughly five minutes' walk from the platforms.

(a) near
(b) next to
(c) beside
(d) by

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

38. There were hundreds of people ___ the concert, all packed ___ the open-air arena.

(a) at ... in
(b) in ... at
(c) at ... at
(d) on ... in

Answer:

_____

Sentence correction

39. Correct the preposition: 'The teacher wrote the date in the top of the whiteboard.'

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

40. The old mill stands ___ the Thames, and a footbridge crosses ___ the river just beside it.

(a) on ... over
(b) in ... on
(c) at ... over
(d) on ... on

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

41. They live ___ 42 Park Lane, ___ the second floor.

(a) at ... on
(b) in ... at
(c) on ... in
(d) at ... in

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

42. By the time I was sitting ___ my car, the other students were already ___ the school bus.

(a) in ... on
(b) on ... in
(c) in ... in
(d) on ... on

Answer:

_____

Rewrite (keep the meaning)

43. Rewrite using 'in front of': 'A tall man was standing before me and blocked my view.'

_____

_____

_____

Error spotting

44. Find and correct the wrong place preposition: 'Meet me on the entrance of the mall at noon.'

_____

_____

_____

Context selection

45. Choose the best option for this notice: 'Cycles must not be parked ___ the fire exit or left ___ the stairwell.'

(a) in front of ... in
(b) in the front of ... on
(c) before ... at
(d) in front of ... at

Answer:

_____

Section C - Movement and Direction

Multiple choice

46. The lorry skidded and crashed ___ the barrier; luckily the driver was still safely ___ his seat.

(a) into ... in
(b) in ... into
(c) into ... into
(d) in ... in

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

47. The gymnast leapt ___ the beam and balanced ___ one foot.

(a) onto ... on
(b) on ... onto
(c) onto ... onto
(d) on ... on

Answer:

_____

Compare the two sentences

48. Explain the difference: (i) 'She walked into the room.' (ii) 'She was walking in the room.'

_____

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

49. The path runs ___ a thick forest and then ___ an open meadow to the river.

(a) through ... across
(b) across ... through
(c) through ... through
(d) across ... across

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

50. We strolled ___ the beach for an hour, then waded ___ the shallow stream to the other bank.

(a) along ... across
(b) across ... along
(c) along ... along
(d) across ... across

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

51. The children ran ___ the tree, chasing each other in circles, before scrambling ___ the low wall.

(a) around ... over
(b) across ... around
(c) around ... across
(d) over ... around

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

52. She walked ___ the gate, opened it and went in; he only walked ___ the gate but turned back before reaching it.

(a) to ... towards
(b) towards ... to
(c) to ... to
(d) towards ... towards

Answer:

_____

Compare the two sentences

53. Explain the difference: (i) 'He ran to the exit.' (ii) 'He ran towards the exit.'

_____

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

54. The firefighter rushed ___ the stairs to the top floor, carried the child, and hurried back ___ to safety.

(a) up ... down
(b) down ... up
(c) up ... up
(d) over ... down

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

55. To reach the lake you walk ___ a narrow tunnel and then ___ an old mill on your right.

(a) through ... past
(b) past ... through
(c) through ... through
(d) across ... past

Answer:

Multiple choice

56. The passengers got ___ the train at the wrong station and had to get ___ the next one.

(a) off ... on
(b) on ... off
(c) off ... off
(d) out ... on

Answer:

Multiple choice

57. The cat shot ___ the frightened dog and darted ___ the room.

(a) away from ... out of
(b) out of ... away from
(c) away from ... away from
(d) from ... out of

Answer:

Sentence correction

58. Correct the movement preposition: 'The children ran across the tunnel to reach the playground.'

Multiple choice

59. The cat jumped ___ the table, knocked a cup ___ the floor, and then curled up ___ a warm spot by the window.

(a) onto ... onto ... in
(b) into ... onto ... on
(c) onto ... into ... in
(d) on ... onto ... in

Answer:

_____

Compare the two sentences

60. Explain the difference: (i) 'The cat jumped onto the chair.' (ii) 'The cat sat on the chair.'

_____

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

61. To reach the stage she pushed her way ___ the packed crowd and then walked ___ the empty dance floor.

(a) through ... across
(b) across ... through
(c) through ... through
(d) across ... across

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

62. Translate the sentence ___ French, and write your answer neatly ___ the box provided.

(a) into ... in
(b) in ... into
(c) to ... in
(d) into ... on

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

63. The skater stepped ___ the ice from the bench, glided for a while, and then stepped ___ again to rest.

(a) onto ... off
(b) on ... off
(c) onto ... from
(d) off ... onto

Answer:

_____

Rewrite (show movement)

64. One moment the dog was in the garden; the next, it was in the kitchen. Rewrite as ONE sentence showing the movement, using 'out of' and 'into'.

_____

_____

_____

Error spotting

65. One movement preposition is wrong. Identify and correct: 'He walked into the bridge to cross the river.'

_____

_____

_____

Dialogue completion

66. Complete with movement prepositions. A: How do I get to the roof? B: Go ___ these stairs to the top, then step ___ the flat roof through the small door.

_____

_____

_____

Context selection

67. Choose the option that fits: 'The parade winds ___ the narrow lanes of the old town, passes ___ the town hall, and ends ___ the main square.'

(a) through ... past ... in
(b) across ... past ... at
(c) into ... by ... in
(d) through ... into ... at

Answer:

_____

Section D - Verbs and Their Prepositions

Multiple choice (choose the correct sentence)

68. Which sentence is correct?

(a) Listen to me and I'll explain the plan to you.
(b) Listen me and I'll explain you the plan.
(c) Listen to me and I'll explain you the plan.
(d) Listen me and I'll explain the plan to you.

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice (choose the correct sentence)

69. Which sentence about a squad is correct?

(a) The squad comprises eleven players.
(b) The squad comprises of eleven players.
(c) The squad is consisted of eleven players.
(d) The squad consist of eleven players.

Answer:

_____

Explain the difference

70. Explain the difference: (i) 'I don't believe you.' (ii) 'I don't believe in you.'

_____

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

71. I agree ___ you that the plan is risky, but in the end, although I still disliked it, I had to agree ___ their decision.

(a) with ... to
(b) to ... with
(c) with ... with
(d) on ... to

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

72. Whom does this bag belong ___? It certainly doesn't belong ___ me.

(a) to ... to
(b) with ... to
(c) to ... with
(d) (no preposition) ... to

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

73. Choose the option: 'The babysitter has to ___ the children while their mother ___ a new job online.'

(a) look after ... looks for
(b) look for ... looks after
(c) look at ... looks for
(d) look after ... looks at

Answer:

_____

Sentence correction

74. Correct any error: 'He requested for a glass of water and asked for the time.'

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

75. She apologised ___ her teacher ___ arriving late.

(a) to ... for
(b) with ... for
(c) to ... of
(d) for ... to

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

76. Heavy rain prevented the match ___ taking place.

(a) from
(b) to
(c) of
(d) for

Answer:

Multiple choice

77. The customers complained ___ the manager ___ the poor service.

(a) to ... about
(b) about ... to
(c) with ... about
(d) to ... of

Answer:

Multiple choice

78. We arrived ___ the airport at noon and finally arrived ___ Delhi by evening.

(a) at ... in
(b) in ... at
(c) at ... at
(d) to ... in

Answer:

Multiple choice

79. Rescuers searched ___ the missing hikers all night.

(a) for
(b) (no preposition)
(c) about
(d) to

Answer:

Multiple choice

80. My grandmother suffers ___ arthritis.

(a) from
(b) of
(c) with
(d) (no preposition)

Answer:

Multiple choice

81. It's unkind to laugh ___ someone who makes a mistake.

(a) at
(b) on
(c) of
(d) with

Answer:

Multiple choice

82. All students are encouraged to participate ___ the science fair.

(a) in
(b) at
(c) on
(d) to

Answer:

Multiple choice

83. He insisted ___ paying for everyone's tickets.

(a) on
(b) to
(c) in
(d) for

Answer:

Multiple choice

84. Do you object ___ my opening the window?

(a) to
(b) against
(c) on
(d) for

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

85. I'm really looking forward ___ you again soon.

(a) to seeing
(b) to see
(c) for seeing
(d) at seeing

Answer:

_____

Choose ALL correct

86. Which of these are correct? Select ALL that apply. (a) 'She is used to waking up early.' (b) 'She is used to wake up early.' (c) 'He confessed to taking the money.' (d) 'They resorted to cheating.'

(a) (a)
(b) (b)
(c) (c)
(d) (d)

Answer:

_____

_____

Sentence correction

87. Correct any error: 'Let's discuss about the project during lunch.'

_____

_____

_____

Sentence correction

88. Correct any error: 'The students entered into the hall quietly.'

_____

_____

_____

Sentence correction

89. Correct any error: 'Please return back the library book by Friday.'

Multiple choice

90. The referee accused the striker ___ diving and blamed him ___ the delay.

(a) of ... for
(b) for ... of
(c) of ... of
(d) with ... for

Answer:

Multiple choice

91. Let me congratulate you ___ your success - it reminds me ___ my own first prize.

(a) on ... of
(b) for ... about
(c) on ... about
(d) for ... of

Answer:

Error spotting

92. One preposition is wrong. Identify and correct: 'She married with a doctor she met at college.'

Dialogue completion

93. Complete with the right prepositions. A: What happened in the meeting? B: They asked me to explain the delay ___ the whole team, and then congratulated me ___ finishing the report early.

Section E - Adjectives and Their Prepositions

Multiple choice

94. She's very good ___ mathematics but rather bad ___ spelling.

(a) at ... at
(b) in ... at
(c) at ... in
(d) with ... at

Answer:

Multiple choice

95. He has always been interested ___ astronomy and fascinated ___ black holes.

(a) in ... by
(b) in ... in
(c) about ... by
(d) on ... with

Answer:

Multiple choice

96. The toddler is afraid ___ the dark and scared ___ loud noises.

(a) of ... of
(b) from ... of
(c) of ... from
(d) with ... of

Answer:

Multiple choice

97. The captain was proud ___ her team and felt responsible ___ their training.

(a) of ... for
(b) for ... of
(c) of ... of
(d) about ... for

Answer:

Multiple choice

98. Her handwriting is quite different ___ mine, though in some ways it is similar ___ my sister's.

(a) from ... to
(b) than ... to
(c) to ... from
(d) from ... from

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

99. The coach was angry ___ the players and angry ___ their careless mistakes.

(a) with ... about
(b) at ... with
(c) about ... with
(d) with ... with

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

100. The town is famous ___ its silk and known ___ its ancient temple.

(a) for ... for
(b) as ... for
(c) for ... as
(d) by ... for

Answer:

_____

Compare the two sentences

101. Explain the difference: (i) 'She is famous as a poet.' (ii) 'She is famous for her poems.'

_____

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

102. By the end she was tired ___ his constant excuses.

(a) of
(b) from
(c) with
(d) by

Answer:

Are both acceptable?

103. In 'We were all surprised ___ the news', are both 'at' and 'by' acceptable? Explain any nuance.

Multiple choice

104. The teacher was pleased ___ our project but a little worried ___ the deadline.

(a) with ... about
(b) about ... with
(c) with ... with
(d) at ... about

Answer:

Multiple choice

105. She is capable ___ great things, perfectly suitable ___ the role, and ready ___ any challenge.

(a) of ... for ... for
(b) for ... of ... for
(c) of ... to ... for
(d) of ... for ... to

Answer:

Multiple choice

106. Are you aware ___ the risks? Despite them, he's very fond ___ rock climbing.

(a) of ... of
(b) about ... of
(c) of ... for
(d) with ... of

Answer:

_____

Sentence correction

107. Correct the adjective + preposition errors: 'He is very keen in football and good in defending.'

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

108. As a teenager he was still dependent ___ his parents, but he longed to be independent ___ them.

(a) on ... of
(b) of ... on
(c) on ... from
(d) upon ... to

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

109. Many people think this phone is superior ___ the older model, and they prefer it ___ any other brand.

(a) to ... to
(b) than ... than
(c) to ... than
(d) from ... to

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

110. The table is made ___ solid oak, paper is made ___ wood pulp, and this cake is made ___ real butter.

(a) of ... from ... with
(b) from ... of ... with
(c) of ... with ... from
(d) with ... from ... of

Answer:

_____

Compare the two sentences

111. Explain the difference: (i) 'Wine is made from grapes.' (ii) 'The bowl is made of glass.'

_____

_____

_____

_____

Choose ALL correct

112. Which are standard/correct? Select ALL that apply. (a) 'She is married to an engineer.' (b) 'He is allergic to peanuts.' (c) 'They are guilty for the crime.' (d) 'I am jealous of his success.'

(a) (a)
(b) (b)
(c) (c)
(d) (d)

Answer:

_____

_____

Multiple choice

113. I'm grateful ___ you ___ your help.

(a) to ... for
(b) for ... to
(c) with ... for
(d) to ... of

Answer:

_____

Error spotting

114. One or more prepositions are wrong. Identify and correct: 'The results were consistent to our earlier findings and similar with last year's.'

Multiple choice

115. Choose the best option: 'She was anxious ___ the interview because she felt she was bad ___ answering tricky questions, though she was keen ___ getting the job.'

(a) about ... at ... on
(b) for ... in ... on
(c) about ... in ... for
(d) of ... at ... on

Answer:

Section F - Unnecessary, Wrong, Missing or Correct

Correct or leave as is

116. State whether the preposition is unnecessary, missing, wrong, or correct - then fix if needed: 'The principal emphasised on the need for discipline.'

Correct or leave as is

117. State whether the preposition is unnecessary, missing, wrong, or correct - then fix if needed: 'Please reply to my email by tomorrow.'

Correct or leave as is

118. State whether the preposition is unnecessary, missing, wrong, or correct - then fix if needed: 'He could not cope up with the pressure.'

Correct or leave as is

119. State whether the preposition is unnecessary, missing, wrong, or correct - then fix if needed: 'The child resembles to his father.'

Correct or leave as is

120. State whether the preposition is unnecessary, missing, wrong, or correct - then fix if needed: 'We reached to the station just in time.'

Multiple choice (choose the correct sentence)

121. Which sentence is correct?

(a) She explained the rules to the new players.
(b) She explained the new players the rules.
(c) She explained about the rules to the new players.
(d) She explained the rules with the new players.

Answer:

Correct or leave as is

122. State whether the particle is needed, unnecessary, or wrong - then explain: 'The manager will look into the matter.'

Correct or leave as is

123. State whether there is a preposition error, and fix it if so: 'They discussed the plan and then voted for it.'

Correct or leave as is

124. State whether the preposition is unnecessary, missing, wrong, or correct - then fix if needed: 'She is not interested to join the club.'

Correct or leave as is

125. State whether the preposition is unnecessary, missing, wrong, or correct - then fix if needed: 'Please listen the instructions carefully.'

Correct or leave as is

126. State whether the preposition is unnecessary, missing, wrong, or correct - then fix if needed: 'The results depend the weather.'

Correct or leave as is

127. State whether the preposition is unnecessary, missing, wrong, or correct - then fix if needed: 'Divide this cake in four pieces.'

Correct or leave as is

128. State whether there is a preposition error, and fix it if so: 'Congratulations on your promotion!'

Classify the use

129. Is 'on' unnecessary, wrong, or acceptable-with-a-different-meaning here? 'She threw the ball on the roof.'

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice (choose the correct sentence)

130. Only one sentence is correct. Which one?

(a) He requested for leave.
(b) He applied for leave.
(c) He demanded for leave.
(d) He ordered for leave.

Answer:

_____

Correct or leave as is

131. State whether the preposition/structure is correct, and fix it if not: 'The teacher asked a question to the class.'

_____

_____

_____

Correct or leave as is

132. State whether the preposition is unnecessary, missing, wrong, or correct - then fix if needed: 'I look forward your reply.'

_____

_____

_____

Correct or leave as is

133. State whether the preposition is unnecessary, missing, wrong, or correct - then fix if needed: 'He is angry on me.'

_____

_____

_____

Correct or leave as is

134. State whether there is a preposition error, and fix it if so: 'They accused him of stealing.'

Choose ALL that are wrong

135. Which sentences contain a preposition error? Select ALL that apply. (a) 'She is good in cooking.' (b) 'He is interested in cooking.' (c) 'We discussed about cooking.' (d) 'They are fond of cooking.'

(a) (a)
(b) (b)
(c) (c)
(d) (d)

Answer:

Correct or leave as is

136. State whether the preposition/structure is correct, and fix it if not: 'Can you explain me this sum?'

Correct or leave as is

137. State whether the preposition is unnecessary, missing, wrong, or correct - then fix if needed: 'The medicine had no effect to the patient.'

Correct or leave as is

138. This sentence looks informal but is it actually wrong? Decide and explain: 'This is the book I told you about.'

Multiple choice (choose the correct sentence)

139. In which sentence is the preposition used correctly?

(a) She married with a lawyer.
(b) He resembles to his uncle.
(c) They are keen on hiking.
(d) We reached to the summit.

Answer:

Section G - Prepositional Phrases

Multiple choice

140. ___ the heavy rain, the match continued; ___ being tired, the players fought on.

(a) In spite of ... Despite
(b) Despite of ... In spite
(c) In spite of ... Despite of
(d) Although ... Despite

Answer:

Multiple choice

141. Choose the traditionally correct option: 'The match was cancelled ___ the storm, and the cancellation was ___ safety concerns.'

(a) because of ... due to
(b) due to ... because of
(c) because of ... because of
(d) owing to ... because of

Answer:

Multiple choice

142. ___ complaining, why not offer a solution? Later she chose tea ___ coffee.

(a) Instead of ... instead of
(b) Instead ... instead of
(c) In spite of ... instead of
(d) Instead of ... instead

Answer:

Multiple choice

143. ___ the weather forecast, it will rain tomorrow.

(a) According to
(b) According
(c) As per to
(d) According with

Answer:

Multiple choice

144. The head girl accepted the trophy ___ the whole school.

(a) on behalf of
(b) on behalf to
(c) in behalf to
(d) on the behalf

Answer:

Multiple choice

145. I am writing ___ your recent complaint.

(a) with regard to
(b) with regards to
(c) in regards to
(d) with regard of

Answer:

Multiple choice

146. ___ his salary, he earns money from tutoring.

(a) In addition to
(b) In addition
(c) Additional to
(d) In addition of

Answer:

Multiple choice

147. The climbers crossed the ravine ___ a rope bridge.

(a) by means of
(b) by means to
(c) with means of
(d) by mean of

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

148. The committee voted ___ the new proposal, and the deputy is ___ the office while the manager is away.

(a) in favour of ... in charge of
(b) in favour to ... in charge for
(c) in favour of ... in charge for
(d) in the favour of ... in charge of

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

149. ___ fire, break the glass and press the alarm.

(a) In case of
(b) In case
(c) In the case
(d) In case for

Answer:

_____

Explain the difference

150. Explain the difference: (i) 'Take an umbrella in case of rain.' (ii) 'Take an umbrella in case it rains.'

_____

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

151. ___ a few small mistakes, your essay is excellent.

(a) Apart from
(b) Apart of
(c) Apart to
(d) Apart

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

152. House prices here are low ___ those in the capital.

(a) in comparison with
(b) in comparison than
(c) in comparison of
(d) comparison to

Answer:

_____

Sentence correction

153. Correct the form: 'Inspite of the traffic, we arrived on time.'

_____

_____

_____

Sentence correction

154. Correct the error: 'She passed the test in spite of she was unwell.'

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

155. ___ working hard, he failed to finish on time.

(a) Despite
(b) Despite of
(c) Although
(d) In spite

Answer:

_____

Choose ALL correct

156. Which are correct ways to start the sentence 'the rain, we went out'? Select ALL that apply. (a) 'Despite the rain, ...' (b) 'Despite of the rain, ...' (c) 'In spite of the rain, ...' (d) 'Although the rain, ...'

(a) (a)
(b) (b)
(c) (c)
(d) (d)

Answer:

Multiple choice

157. Choose the best phrase: 'Speaking ___ the residents, she argued strongly ___ the new park and was later put ___ the planning committee.'

(a) on behalf of ... in favour of ... in charge of
(b) in favour of ... on behalf of ... in charge of
(c) on behalf of ... in charge of ... in favour of
(d) in charge of ... in favour of ... on behalf of

Answer:

Multiple choice

158. ___ your question, the answer is yes; and ___ the cost, we will proceed.

(a) With regard to ... regardless of
(b) Regardless of ... with regard to
(c) With regards to ... regardless of
(d) With regard to ... regardless to

Answer:

Multiple choice

159. Choose the best option: 'The door opens ___ a keypad; ___ a power cut, use the metal key; ___ that, keep a torch nearby.'

(a) by means of ... in case of ... in addition to
(b) in case of ... by means of ... in addition to
(c) by means of ... in addition to ... in case of
(d) in addition to ... in case of ... by means of

Answer:

Sentence correction

160. Correct the prepositional-phrase errors: 'Inspite of the delay, and according with the notice, refunds will be given to all passengers.'

Section H - Meaning Change Through Preposition Choice

Compare the two sentences

161. Explain the difference: (i) 'He threw the ball to me.' (ii) 'He threw the ball at me.'

Multiple choice

162. Which word shows the thief was AIMING to hit the guard? 'The thief hurled a stone ___ the guard.'

(a) at
(b) to
(c) for
(d) toward

Answer:

Compare the two sentences

163. Explain the difference: (i) 'The plane flew over the town.' (ii) 'The plane flew above the clouds.'

Compare the two sentences

164. Explain the difference: (i) 'She walked across the field.' (ii) 'She walked through the field.'

Compare the two sentences

165. Explain the difference (say if it is small): (i) 'I spoke to the manager.' (ii) 'I spoke with the manager.'

Compare the two sentences

166. Explain the difference: (i) 'The letter was written by Gandhi.' (ii) 'The letter was written with a fountain pen.'

Multiple choice

167. Choose the option that names the TOOL used: 'The sculpture was carved ___ a chisel ___ a local artist.'

(a) with ... by
(b) by ... with
(c) with ... with
(d) by ... by

Answer:

Compare the two sentences

168. Explain the difference: (i) 'She sat by the window.' (ii) 'She sat near the window.'

Compare the two sentences

169. Explain the difference: (i) 'She ran into her old teacher at the market.' (ii) 'She ran to her old teacher at the market.'

Compare the two sentences

170. Explain any difference: (i) 'a book about science' (ii) 'a book on science'.

Compare the two sentences

171. Explain the difference: (i) 'She cares about her students.' (ii) 'She cares for her students.'

Multiple choice

172. Which shows that the nurse LOOKS AFTER the patients? 'The nurse cares ___ the patients day and night.'

(a) for
(b) about
(c) of
(d) with

Answer:

Compare the two sentences

173. Explain any difference: (i) 'I dream of becoming a pilot.' (ii) 'I dreamt about flying last night.'

Compare the two sentences

174. Explain the difference: (i) 'What do you think of my plan?' (ii) 'I need to think about your plan.'

Compare three sentences

175. Explain the difference between: (i) 'Did you hear the news?' (ii) 'Have you heard of this band?' (iii) 'Have you heard from your sister?'

Compare the two sentences

176. Explain the difference: (i) 'The flood resulted in huge damage.' (ii) 'The damage resulted from the flood.'

Multiple choice

177. Which preposition makes the sentence mean the delay CAUSED the loss? 'The heavy loss resulted ___ the long delay.'

(a) from
(b) in
(c) of
(d) to

Answer:

Compare the two sentences

178. Explain the difference: (i) 'The teacher talked to the students.' (ii) 'The teacher talked at the students.'

Compare the two sentences

179. Explain the difference: (i) 'He shouted at the boy.' (ii) 'He shouted to the boy.'

Compare the two sentences

180. Explain the difference: (i) 'The team consists of eleven players.' (ii) 'True happiness consists in contentment.'

_____

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

181. Which sentence means the author PERSONALLY contacted you?

(a) I heard the announcement.
(b) I heard of the author.
(c) I heard from the author.
(d) I heard about the author.

Answer:

_____

Section I - Abstract and Non-Physical Prepositions

Multiple choice

182. We usually travel ___ train, but yesterday we went ___ car.

(a) by ... by
(b) on ... in
(c) by ... in
(d) on ... by

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

183. He earns a living ___ teaching, and he marks the essays ___ a red pen.

(a) by ... with
(b) with ... by
(c) by ... by
(d) with ... with

Answer:

_____

Compare the two sentences

184. Explain the usual difference: (i) 'She died of cancer.' (ii) 'He died from his injuries.'

_____

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

185. Half the class voted ___ the school trip, while the other half voted ___ it.

(a) for ... against
(b) to ... against
(c) for ... versus
(d) with ... against

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

186. All the players trained hard ___ the goalkeeper, who was injured; and ___ training, they also studied match videos.

(a) except ... besides
(b) besides ... except
(c) except for ... beside
(d) besides ... besides

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

187. This drink is made ___ real oranges, and the smell ___ oranges filled the room.

(a) from ... of
(b) of ... from
(c) from ... from
(d) of ... of

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

188. Scientists found a clear connection ___ smoking and lung disease.

(a) between
(b) among
(c) with
(d) of

Answer:

Multiple choice

189. The committee published a report ___ road safety, and a child wrote a story ___ a magic train.

(a) on ... about
(b) about ... on
(c) on ... on
(d) about ... about

Answer:

Multiple choice

190. I found this flat ___ a friend who works at an agency.

(a) through
(b) by
(c) from
(d) with

Answer:

Multiple choice

191. She returned the wallet ___ honesty, not ___ fear of being caught.

(a) out of ... out of
(b) from ... of
(c) out of ... in
(d) of ... out of

Answer:

Multiple choice

192. The bridge is currently ___ construction, and the cause of the collapse is ___ investigation.

(a) under ... under
(b) in ... under
(c) on ... in
(d) under ... in

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

193. The instructions were ___ my understanding, and the noise was ___ belief.

(a) beyond ... beyond
(b) above ... beyond
(c) over ... above
(d) beyond ... above

Answer:

_____

Correct or leave as is

194. State whether there is a preposition error, and fix it if so: 'She was trembling with fear and could not speak because of nervousness.'

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

195. He was shaking ___ anger and his face was red ___ embarrassment.

(a) with ... with
(b) of ... from
(c) from ... with
(d) by ... with

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

196. She takes vitamins ___ her health and wears a helmet ___ injury.

(a) for ... against
(b) for ... for
(c) to ... against
(d) against ... for

Answer:

_____

Compare the two sentences

197. Explain the difference: (i) 'I'm afraid of my dog.' (ii) 'I'm afraid for my dog.'

_____

_____

_____

_____

Multiple choice

198. The country was ___ chaos, the soldiers stood ___ silence, and the plan lay ___ ruins.

(a) in ... in ... in
(b) on ... in ... in
(c) in ... on ... in
(d) at ... in ... on

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

199. She was thrilled ___ the good news but alarmed ___ the sudden change of plan.

(a) at ... at
(b) on ... at
(c) at ... on
(d) with ... on

Answer:

_____

Multiple choice

200. Choose the best set: 'She kept calm ___ the crisis, acted ___ the interest of everyone, and stayed ___ control throughout.'

(a) during ... in ... in
(b) in ... on ... under
(c) during ... on ... in
(d) at ... in ... under

Answer:

Answer Key and Reasoning

Each entry gives the correct answer, a full explanation, why the other options are wrong (and the misconception each represents), the grammar principle, a memory tip, the difficulty (out of 10) and the main thinking skill being tested.

Section A - Prepositions of Time

Q1. (Multiple choice)

Answer: for ... by

Explanation: "for + a length of time" states duration (for six weeks); "by + a point in time" states a deadline the finishing must not pass (by the middle of March).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) "since six weeks" treats a length as a start point (misconception: since = for, from Hindi 'se'); "until March" wrongly says the programme continues up to March. (c) "during" needs an event noun, not a measured length (during/for confusion). (d) "finished until March" says the finishing keeps happening up to March; a completed action needs by, not until.

Grammar principle: for measures how long; by marks a deadline; until marks a state continuing up to a point; during locates an action inside a named period.

Memory tip: "by" is a finish line; "until" is the road running up to that line.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Distinguishing duration, deadline and continuation

Q2. (Multiple choice)

Answer: until ... by

Explanation: "stay until ten" is a continuing state that lasts up to a point; "locked by ten" is a single completed action with a deadline.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) reversed: "stay by ten" is wrong because staying is continuous; "locked until ten" means it stays locked up to ten. (c) "stay for ten o'clock" wrongly uses for with a clock time instead of a length. (d) "locked until ten" again gives the wrong meaning.

Grammar principle: Continuing states take until; one-off completions take by.

Memory tip: You wait until a time; you deliver by a time.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** by vs until

Q3. (Multiple choice)

Answer: at ... on ... at

Explanation: at + clock time (8:15); on + a specific day (Monday morning is a named day, so on, not in); at the start is a fixed phrase.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b)/(c)/(d) permute the rules wrongly: "on 8:15", "in 8:15" and "in Monday morning" all break the pattern. The common trap is using "in the morning" logic for "on Monday morning" (a specific day forces on).

Grammar principle: at a point in the clock; on a day; in a span such as a month or year.

Memory tip: at a time, on a day, in a bigger span.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** in / on / at with time

Q4. (Multiple choice)

Answer: since ... for

Explanation: since + the point where something began (2021), used with the present perfect; for + the length of time (five years).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swaps them ("for 2021" and "since five years" are both wrong). (c) "from 2021" needs an end point (from 2021 to now); with a still-continuing period the correct word is since. (d) "for ... from" is nonsense here.

Grammar principle: since marks the beginning of a still-continuing period; for measures its length.

Memory tip: since points back to a moment; for measures the stretch.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** since vs for

Q5. (Multiple choice)

Answer: on time ... in time

Explanation: on time = punctual, exactly as scheduled (the train left at 9:00); in time (to do something) = early enough, with time to spare.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) a train leaving "exactly in time" is wrong; leaving as scheduled is on time. (c)/(d) repeat one phrase and lose the contrast: "arrived on time to jump aboard" drops the 'with enough time' sense that in time carries.

Grammar principle: on time = according to the schedule; in time (for/to) = soon enough.

Memory tip: on time = the clock agrees; in time = you made it before the door shut.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Fixed time phrases: on time vs in time

Q6. (Explain the difference)

Answer: (i) in an hour = after a full hour has passed / it takes about an hour, so the natural reading is 'ready at the end of roughly sixty minutes'. (ii) within an hour = at some point before an hour passes - any time up to sixty minutes, possibly much sooner; 'within' stresses the outer limit.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: The usual error is treating them as identical. The point missed is that 'in + period' lands on the end of the period, while 'within + period' allows anything up to that end.

Grammar principle: in + time = at the end of that span; within + time = at or before the end of that span.

Memory tip: 'in' lands on the hour mark; 'within' lands anywhere inside the hour.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Semantic contrast of near-synonyms

Q7. (Multiple choice)

Answer: in the end ... at the end

Explanation: in the end = finally, as the eventual outcome after a process; at the end (of something) = at the final point of a thing (the last scene).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swapped: "at the end the play was a hit" reads as a point in time, not an outcome, and "bowed in the end of the last scene" is wrong. (c)/(d) repeat one phrase and so mismatch one meaning. Trap: assuming the two phrases are interchangeable.

Grammar principle: in the end = the final result after everything; at the end (of X) = the final point of X.

Memory tip: in the end = 'after all that'; at the end = 'the tail of it'.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Idiomatic time phrases

Q8. (Multiple choice)

Answer: before ... by

Explanation: before + an event/clause ('before the bell rings'); by + a clock time as a deadline, which pairs naturally with 'at the latest'.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) "by the bell rings" is wrong because by cannot take a clause (you would need 'by the time'); 'seated before 9:30 at the latest' clashes with the deadline sense. (c) "reach until the bell" is wrong. (d) "seated until 9:30" means staying seated up to 9:30 - wrong meaning.

Grammar principle: before + a clause or event; by + a deadline point (often with 'at the latest').

Memory tip: before = earlier than that moment; by = no later than that moment.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** before vs by

Q9. (Fill in the blank)

Answer: since

Explanation: The present perfect ('has collected') with a start point (a year) takes since.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: 'for 1998' treats a point as a length (since/for confusion); 'from 1998' needs an end point, e.g. 'from 1998 to 2005'.

Grammar principle: since marks the beginning of a period that is still going on.

Memory tip: since = 'starting from that year and still going'.

Difficulty: 4/10 | **Cognitive skill:** since with a start point

Q10. (Multiple choice)

Answer: During ... for

Explanation: during + a named event (the thunderstorm); for + a measured length of time (two hours).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) "For the thunderstorm the lights flickered" changes the meaning of for to purpose; "off during two hours" wrongly uses during with a length. (c) "Since the thunderstorm" means 'ever since', changing the meaning. (d) "off since two hours" is wrong.

Grammar principle: during answers 'inside which event?'; for answers 'how long?'.

Memory tip: during locates you inside an event; for measures the clock.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** during vs for

Q11. (Sentence correction)

Answer: 'since three years' should be 'for three years': 'She has been living in Pune for three years.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Keeping since is the classic error (Hindi/regional 'se' covers both since and for). since needs a start point (since 2021), not a duration.

Grammar principle: since + a point in time; for + a duration.

Memory tip: If you can answer 'how long?', use for.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Error detection: since/for

Q12. (Are both acceptable?)

Answer: Yes - both are acceptable and mean roughly the same (at some time in, or throughout, the holidays). 'over' is a little more informal and stresses spanning the whole stretch; 'during' is neutral and simply places the stay inside that period.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Errors: assuming only one can be correct; or reading 'over' here as 'above'. Over and during both have a 'in the course of a period' meaning.

Grammar principle: over and during can both mean 'in the course of' a period; the difference is register/emphasis, not grammar.

Memory tip: over = across the whole span; during = somewhere inside the span - usually interchangeable for holidays.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Recognising acceptable alternatives

Q13. (Multiple choice)

Answer: at ... at

Explanation: at night and at dawn are fixed: night, dawn, noon and midnight are treated as points and take at (unlike 'in the morning/evening').

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b)/(d) "in night" is wrong; (c) "in dawn" is wrong. Trap: applying the 'in the morning' pattern to night/dawn.

Grammar principle: at night, at dawn, at noon, at midnight (points); but in the morning/afternoon/evening.

Memory tip: night, noon, dawn, midnight are pinpoints - use at.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Fixed time expressions

Q14. (Rewrite (keep the meaning))

Answer: 'You must return the equipment by Friday.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Using until ('return until Friday') changes it into a continuous action; till has the same problem. 'No later than' is exactly the deadline meaning of by.

Grammar principle: by expresses a deadline = 'not later than'.

Memory tip: 'no later than' is just a long way of saying by.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Paraphrase with a deadline preposition

Q15. (Multiple choice)

Answer: between ... and

Explanation: between ... and ... is the correct correlative pair for a span between two times.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) mixes pairs: from goes with to, not and. (c) mixes pairs: between goes with and, not to. (d) 'since 12' needs a present-perfect start point. Trap: crossing the two fixed pairs.

Grammar principle: between ... and ...; from ... to ... - never cross the pairs.

Memory tip: between marries and; from marries to.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Correlative preposition pairs

Q16. (Multiple choice)

Answer: in

Explanation: in + a future period = at the end of that period counting from now ('in a few days' = a few days from now).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) since needs a past start point. (c) for gives a duration, the wrong meaning. (d) by needs a definite point ('by Friday'), not a vague length. Trap: using for or by for 'a few days from now'.

Grammar principle: in + period (future) = at the end of that period from now.

Memory tip: 'in a few days' = a few days from now.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Future use of in

Q17. (Explain the difference)

Answer: Waiting is a continuous action that lasts up to a point, so it needs until (up to 6). by marks the deadline for a single completed action ('finish by 6', 'arrive by 6'). You cannot 'wait by 6' because waiting is not a one-moment event.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: treating by and until as interchangeable. The verb's type decides the choice.

Grammar principle: until = a state lasting up to a point (ongoing actions); by = a deadline for a completed action.

Memory tip: Ongoing action -> until. One-and-done action -> by.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Reasoning about action type

Q18. (Multiple choice)

Answer: on ... in

Explanation: on + a specific date (26 January); in + a year (1950).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) "in 26 January" is wrong; (c) "at 26 January" is wrong; (d) "at 1950" is wrong. Trap: mismatching date and year rules.

Grammar principle: on + a specific date; in + a year.

Memory tip: on the day, in the year.

Difficulty: 4/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Dates and years

Q19. (Dialogue completion)

Answer: on (the 14th) ... for (three days).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: 'in the 14th' or 'at the 14th' is wrong (dates take on); 'since three days' or 'during three days' is wrong (a duration takes for).

Grammar principle: on + a date; for + a duration.

Memory tip: on a date, for a stretch.

Difficulty: 4/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Applying time rules in dialogue

Q20. (Multiple choice)

Answer: in ... in

Explanation: in + a season (summer); in + a month (May/June).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) "at summer" is wrong; (c) "on summer" is wrong; (d) "on June" is wrong. Trap: using at/on for large spans.

Grammar principle: in + seasons, months and years (big spans of time).

Memory tip: big spans of time -> in.

Difficulty: 4/10 | **Cognitive skill:** in with seasons and months

Q21. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) is correct: in two hours = the task took two hours to complete. (ii) is wrong: for two hours describes how long a continuing action lasted, but 'finish' is a single completed moment. (Note 'I wrote the essay for two hours' is fine, because writing is ongoing.)

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: assuming for always marks a length of time regardless of the verb. Completion verbs (finish, arrive) do not take for + duration.

Grammar principle: for + duration suits continuing actions; completion verbs take in for the time taken.

Memory tip: You do something for a while, but you complete it in a certain time.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Matching preposition to verb aspect

Q22. (Multiple choice)

Answer: At ... in

Explanation: at the age of ... (age is treated as a point); in + a year (2020).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) "In the age of ten" is wrong; (c) "On the age" is wrong; (d) "on 2020" is wrong. Trap: mismatching 'at the age of' and 'in + year'.

Grammar principle: at the age of ...; in + year.

Memory tip: 'at' pins a point (an age); 'in' holds a year.

Difficulty: 4/10 | **Cognitive skill:** at with points, in with years

Q23. (Multiple choice)

Answer: since ... for

Explanation: since + a past-event clause ('since we quarrelled'), used with the present perfect; for + the length of time (almost a month).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swaps them. (c) "from we quarrelled" is wrong because from does not take this clause; since is required. (d) "for ... from" is nonsense here.

Grammar principle: since can introduce a clause marking when something began; for gives the length.

Memory tip: since = 'starting when X happened'; for = 'lasting this long'.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** since + clause vs for

Q24. (Sentence correction)

Answer: 'on Tuesday at 3 p.m.': 'The meeting is scheduled on Tuesday at 3 p.m.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: 'at Tuesday' is wrong (days take on); 'in 3 p.m.' is wrong (clock times take at). Trap: swapping the in/on/at rules.

Grammar principle: on + a day; at + a clock time.

Memory tip: on the day, at the time.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Correcting in/on/at

Section B - Place and Position

Q25. (Multiple choice)

Answer: at ... in

Explanation: at + a specific point/location (the bus stop); 'in front of' is a fixed phrase.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) "in the bus stop" is wrong - you wait at a stop. (c) "on front of" is not a phrase. (d) "on the bus stop" is wrong. Trap: breaking the fixed phrase 'in front of'.

Grammar principle: at for a specific point/location; 'in front of' is one unbreakable unit.

Memory tip: at pins you to a spot; 'in front of' is a single locked phrase.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** at for a point + fixed phrase

Q26. (Multiple choice)

Answer: at ... in

Explanation: arrive at + a building/place (the cinema); in + a row (seats are in a row).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b)/(d) 'arrive in the cinema' is wrong - arrive in is for towns/countries, arrive at for buildings. (b) 'seats at row H' and (c) 'seats on row H' are wrong; rows take in.

Grammar principle: arrive at + a building/place; arrive in + a town/country; in + a row.

Memory tip: You arrive at a building but in a city; you sit in a row.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** arrive at/in + in a row

Q27. (Multiple choice)

Answer: over

Explanation: over can mean covering or spanning a surface; a blanket covers the baby, so over.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) above = at a higher level with no contact/covering - wrong, a blanket covers. (c) 'on top' needs 'of' ('on top of'). (d) 'upon' = on/onto and gives the wrong picture. Trap: confusing 'higher than' (above) with 'covering' (over).

Grammar principle: over = covering or spanning a surface; above = simply higher up.

Memory tip: A blanket goes over you (covering); a lamp hangs above you (higher up).

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** over vs above (covering vs level)

Q28. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) above = at a higher position, staying put (a vertical relationship, often static). (ii) over = crossing/passing across the top of it (movement across, or covering the whole area). 'Above' says it is higher; 'over' says it passed across or spans it.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: treating them as identical; forgetting that over often implies crossing or covering.

Grammar principle: above = higher level (position); over = across the top / covering (often movement).

Memory tip: above = simply higher; over = across or on top of.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Semantic contrast: above vs over

Q29. (Multiple choice)

Answer: below ... below

Explanation: below zero / below freezing: points on a scale (temperature, marks, sea level) take below, not under.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b)/(c)/(d) use under for scale values, which is wrong; under is for a physical position beneath something, not for a level on a scale.

Grammar principle: Use below (not under) for measurements/levels on a scale.

Memory tip: On a scale - temperature, marks, sea level - it's below, not under.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** below vs under (scale vs physical)

Q30. (Multiple choice)

Answer: Besides ... beside

Explanation: Besides = in addition to (his textbooks); beside = next to (his desk).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swapped: 'Beside his textbooks' means physically next to them, and 'a dictionary besides his desk' is wrong. (c)/(d) repeat one word and mismatch a meaning. Trap: the single letter 's' flips the meaning.

Grammar principle: beside = next to (position); besides = in addition to / apart from.

Memory tip: The extra 's' in besides means 'something extra'.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** beside vs besides

Q31. (Multiple choice)

Answer: between ... among

Explanation: between the three founders: they are distinct, individually linked parties, so between works even for three; among the wider staff: an undifferentiated group/mass.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swapped: 'among the three founders' hides their individual link, and 'spread between the wider staff' wrongly treats a mass as separate parties. (c)/(d) ignore the distinction. Trap: the myth that between is only for two.

Grammar principle: between = individually distinct parties (even several); among = an undivided group/mass.

Memory tip: between = named individuals linked to each other; among = a crowd.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** between vs among (distinct vs mass)

Q32. (Explain the error in the rule)

Answer: Example: 'There is close cooperation between France, Germany and Italy.' Here between links three countries because they are treated as separate parties with links to one another. between is used whenever items are seen as distinct individuals; among is for an undivided group. So 'two only' is an oversimplification.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: the memorised 'two = between, three or more = among' rule. Number is not the deciding factor.

Grammar principle: The deciding factor is distinctness of the parties, not how many there are.

Memory tip: If you can picture the items as separate points linked to each other, use between - however many there are.

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Critiquing an oversimplified rule

Q33. (Multiple choice)

Answer: at ... at

Explanation: at home / at work / at school are fixed location phrases with at.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) "in home" is wrong; (c) 'in work' (BrE colloquial 'in work' = employed) is not the intended 'at the workplace' meaning and is misleading; (d) both wrong. Trap: using in for these fixed phrases.

Grammar principle: at home / at work / at school are fixed phrases.

Memory tip: These three go with at, not in.

Difficulty: 4/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Fixed location phrases

Q34. (Multiple choice)

Answer: opposite

Explanation: opposite = directly facing, on the other side, across from.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'in front of' = ahead of / on the front side, not across the road - it confuses 'facing across' with 'ahead of'. (c) 'before' is mainly time/order, not physical facing. (d) 'beside' = next to, not across.

Grammar principle: opposite = directly facing / on the other side; in front of = ahead of / on the front side.

Memory tip: opposite = face to face across a gap; in front of = standing before it on the same side.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** opposite vs in front of

Q35. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) in front of the hotel = right before its entrance, on the hotel's own side of the road. (ii) opposite the hotel = across the street, facing it. So (i) is at the hotel's door; (ii) is on the far side of the road.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: assuming both describe the same spot.

Grammar principle: in front of = directly before (same side); opposite = across from (other side).

Memory tip: in front of = at its face; opposite = across from its face.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Spatial semantics

Q36. (Multiple choice)

Answer: out of ... outside

Explanation: out of the office = away / not present; outside the meeting room = positioned just beyond it.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'outside the office today' means physically just beyond the building, not the intended 'away/unavailable'; 'waiting out of the meeting room' is wrong (out of = motion/absence). (c)/(d) repeat and mismatch a meaning.

Grammar principle: out of = away from / not in a state (motion or absence); outside = positioned beyond something (static).

Memory tip: out of = not in it (gone/away); outside = standing just beyond it.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** out of vs outside

Q37. (Multiple choice)

Answer: near

Explanation: near = in the general vicinity, not touching; a five-minute walk fits near.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) next to = immediately adjacent - contradicts 'five minutes away'. (c) beside = right alongside - same problem. (d) by = right beside/very close - contradicts the distance.

Grammar principle: near = in the general vicinity; next to / beside / by = immediately adjacent.

Memory tip: next to means touching-close; near means 'around there'.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Degrees of proximity

Q38. (Multiple choice)

Answer: at ... in

Explanation: at + an event (the concert); in + an enclosed space (the arena).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'in the concert' is odd (you attend at an event) and 'packed at the arena' is wrong. (c) 'packed at the arena' is wrong. (d) 'on the concert' is wrong.

Grammar principle: at + an event; in + an enclosed space.

Memory tip: at the event, in the enclosure.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** at (event) vs in (space)

Q39. (Sentence correction)

Answer: 'in the top' should be 'at the top': 'The teacher wrote the date at the top of the whiteboard.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Using in for a position on a surface is the error; 'at the top / at the bottom' is the fixed phrase for positions on a page or board.

Grammar principle: at the top / at the bottom for positions on a surface.

Memory tip: top and bottom of a page or board take at.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** at with top/bottom

Q40. (Multiple choice)

Answer: on ... over

Explanation: A building/settlement 'stands on' a river (e.g. 'a town on the Ganges'); a bridge goes over the water.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'in the Thames' = inside the water, wrong. (c) 'at the Thames' is not idiomatic for 'situated on a river'. (d) 'crosses on the river' is wrong; bridges go over.

Grammar principle: Settlements sit on a river; bridges go over water.

Memory tip: 'Stratford-on-Avon' - places are on their river; bridges arch over.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** on (river) + over (bridge)

Q41. (Multiple choice)

Answer: at ... on

Explanation: at + a specific house number/address (42 Park Lane); on + a floor (the second floor).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'in 42 Park Lane' and 'at the second floor' are wrong. (c) 'on 42' and 'in the second floor' are wrong. (d) 'in the second floor' is wrong.

Grammar principle: at + a specific address/number; on + a floor.

Memory tip: at the exact number, on the floor.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** at (address) + on (floor)

Q42. (Multiple choice)

Answer: in ... on

Explanation: You sit in a car/taxi, but you are on a bus/train/plane/ship.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swapped: 'on my car' means on the roof, and 'in the school bus' is not the idiom. (c) 'in the school bus' is less idiomatic than on. (d) 'on my car' = on top.

Grammar principle: You sit in a small private vehicle (car/taxi) but on a large public one (bus/train/plane).

Memory tip: Small private vehicle -> in; large public vehicle you can walk about in -> on.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** in (car) vs on (bus)

Q43. (Rewrite (keep the meaning))

Answer: 'A tall man was standing in front of me and blocked my view.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Thinking before is only about time is the error; here it means position, so 'in front of' fits.

Grammar principle: before can mean 'in front of' (position) as well as 'earlier than' (time).

Memory tip: 'standing before the judge' = standing in front of the judge.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** before (place) = in front of

Q44. (Error spotting)

Answer: 'on the entrance' should be 'at the entrance': 'Meet me at the entrance of the mall at noon.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Using on for a meeting point is the error; at is used for meeting points and specific spots.

Grammar principle: at + a meeting point / specific location (at the entrance, at the gate, at the corner).

Memory tip: Meeting spots take at.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** at for meeting points

Q45. (Context selection)

Answer: in front of ... in

Explanation: in front of the fire exit = blocking its front, outside it; in the stairwell = inside the stairwell.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'in the front of the fire exit' means the front part inside it (in front of vs in the front of), and 'on the stairwell' is wrong. (c) 'before the fire exit' is ambiguous/time-like and 'at the stairwell' is a point, not 'inside'. (d) 'at the stairwell' is a point, not 'inside'.

Grammar principle: in front of (outside, facing) is not the same as in the front of (the front area inside); in + an enclosed space.

Memory tip: in front of = outside its face; in the front of = the front part inside it.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** in front of vs in the front of

Section C - Movement and Direction

Q46. (Multiple choice)

Answer: into ... in

Explanation: crash into = movement ending in impact (into); 'in his seat' = a static position.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'crashed in the barrier' loses the impact-movement, and 'into his seat' wrongly suggests motion for a driver sitting still. (c) 'into his seat' is wrong. (d) 'crashed in the barrier' is wrong. Trap: using 'in' after a strong movement verb.

Grammar principle: into = movement ending in contact/inside; in = a static position.

Memory tip: into crosses a boundary; in is already inside.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** into (movement) vs in (position)

Q47. (Multiple choice)

Answer: onto ... on

Explanation: leapt onto the beam = movement onto a surface; balanced on one foot = position.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'leapt on the beam' can read as 'pounced on it'; 'balanced onto one foot' is wrong (onto = motion). (c) 'balanced onto one foot' is wrong. (d) 'leapt on the beam' loses the 'jump up and land on top' sense.

Grammar principle: onto = movement onto a surface; on = position on a surface.

Memory tip: onto lands you on top; on keeps you there.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** onto vs on

Q48. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) into = she entered the room from outside (movement across the doorway). (ii) in = she was already inside, walking about within it. So (i) is about entering; (ii) is about moving around inside.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: treating in and into as the same after a movement verb.

Grammar principle: into = crossing into a space; in = movement or position within a space.

Memory tip: into = through the door; in = pacing around inside.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Motion across a boundary vs motion within

Q49. (Multiple choice)

Answer: through ... across

Explanation: through a forest = movement within an enclosing mass; across an open meadow = movement over a flat, open surface.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swapped: 'across a forest' loses the 'among the trees' sense, and 'through an open meadow' wrongly treats open flat ground as enclosing. (c)/(d) apply one word to both.

Grammar principle: through = within something enclosing (forest, tunnel, crowd, water); across = over a flat surface / side to side.

Memory tip: through = surrounded on all sides; across = over the top, edge to edge.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** through vs across

Q50. (Multiple choice)

Answer: along ... across

Explanation: along the beach = following its length; across the stream = from one side to the other.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'across the beach' = from sea to dunes (not the long walk intended); 'along the stream' = following its length (not crossing). (c)/(d) apply one word to both.

Grammar principle: along = following the length of something; across = from one side to the other.

Memory tip: along = lengthwise; across = side to side.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** along vs across

Q51. (Multiple choice)

Answer: around ... over

Explanation: around the tree = in a circle / on all sides; over the low wall = across the top of a barrier.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'across the tree' is odd, and 'around the wall' = round its ends (not scrambling over it). (c) 'across the wall' loses the 'climb over' sense. (d) 'over the tree' is wrong (they circle it).

Grammar principle: around = in a circle / on all sides; over = across the top of a barrier.

Memory tip: around = circling; over = climbing across the top.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** around vs over

Q52. (Multiple choice)

Answer: to ... towards

Explanation: walked to the gate = reached it (a destination); walked towards the gate = moved in its direction without reaching it.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swapped: reaching and using the gate needs 'to', and 'to the gate but turned back before reaching it' contradicts 'to' (which implies arrival). (c)/(d) apply one word to both and clash with 'reaching / not reaching'.

Grammar principle: to = movement that reaches a destination; towards = movement in a direction, arrival not stated.

Memory tip: to = you get there; towards = you just face that way.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** to vs towards (destination vs direction)

Q53. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) to = he reached the exit (it was his destination). (ii) towards = he ran in the direction of the exit, but whether he reached it is not stated - he may have stopped or been interrupted.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: treating to and towards as identical.

Grammar principle: to states arrival at a destination; towards states only the direction.

Memory tip: 'to' guarantees arrival; 'towards' only points the way.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Destination vs direction

Q54. (Multiple choice)

Answer: up ... down

Explanation: up the stairs = to a higher place (the top floor); back down = to a lower place.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'rushed down the stairs to the top floor' contradicts 'top floor'. (c) 'hurried back up to safety' contradicts returning to the ground. (d) 'over the stairs' is wrong.

Grammar principle: up = to a higher place; down = to a lower place.

Memory tip: up climbs, down descends - match direction to destination.

Difficulty: 4/10 | **Cognitive skill:** up vs down

Q55. (Multiple choice)

Answer: through ... past

Explanation: through a narrow tunnel = movement inside an enclosing passage; past an old mill = going by it, leaving it behind.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'past a narrow tunnel' loses the 'go inside it' sense, and 'through an old mill' means entering the mill (not intended). (c) 'through an old mill' means entering it. (d) 'across a narrow tunnel' is wrong (a tunnel is entered, not crossed).

Grammar principle: through = movement inside an enclosing thing; past = movement by/beyond an object.

Memory tip: through = you go inside it; past = you go by it.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** through vs past

Q56. (Multiple choice)

Answer: off ... on

Explanation: get off the train = leave a bus/train/plane; get on the next one = board it.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) reversed: boarding the wrong train then leaving the next contradicts the story. (c) 'get off the next one' is wrong. (d) 'got out the train' is wrong - we say get off a train (get out of is for cars).

Grammar principle: get on / get off a bus, train, plane, ship; get in / get out of a car or taxi.

Memory tip: On/off large public transport; in/out of a car.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** on/off with transport

Q57. (Multiple choice)

Answer: away from ... out of

Explanation: away from the dog = fleeing, increasing distance; out of the room = exiting an enclosed space.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'out of the frightened dog' is wrong (a dog is not a container), and 'darted away from the room' weakens the 'exit through the door' sense. (c) 'darted away from the room' loses the exit sense. (d) 'from the dog' sounds like the cat originated from the dog; 'away from' is the natural fleeing phrase.

Grammar principle: away from = movement increasing distance from something; out of = movement exiting an enclosed space.

Memory tip: away from = putting distance between; out of = coming out of a space.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** away from vs out of

Q58. (Sentence correction)

Answer: 'across the tunnel' should be 'through the tunnel': 'The children ran through the tunnel to reach the playground.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Treating an enclosing passage (tunnel) as a flat surface to cross is the error; tunnels, forests and crowds take through.

Grammar principle: through = movement inside an enclosing space; across = over a flat surface.

Memory tip: You go through a tunnel (inside it), not across it.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Correcting through/across

Q59. (Multiple choice)

Answer: onto ... onto ... in

Explanation: jumped onto the table (movement onto a surface); knocked a cup onto the floor (movement onto a surface); curled up in a warm spot (position within a spot).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'jumped into the table' is wrong (a table is a surface, not a container). (c) 'knocked a cup into the floor' is wrong. (d) 'jumped on the table' loses the landing-movement (on = position).

Grammar principle: onto = movement onto a surface; into = movement into a container; on/in = the resulting position.

Memory tip: onto lands you on a surface; into puts you inside a container.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** onto vs into vs in

Q60. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) onto shows movement - the cat moved from elsewhere up onto the chair. (ii) on shows position - the cat is simply resting there, no movement implied.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: using on after a movement verb where onto is needed.

Grammar principle: onto = movement to a surface; on = static position on a surface.

Memory tip: onto = the jump; on = the sitting.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Movement vs position

Q61. (Multiple choice)

Answer: through ... across

Explanation: through the packed crowd = moving amid a mass that surrounds you; across the empty dance floor = over a flat open surface.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'across the packed crowd' loses the 'in the midst of' sense, and 'through the empty dance floor' wrongly treats open flat ground as enclosing. (c)/(d) apply one word to both.

Grammar principle: through = within/among an enclosing mass (crowd, forest, water); across = over a flat surface.

Memory tip: A crowd surrounds you -> through; a floor is flat under you -> across.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** through vs across (crowd vs floor)

Q62. (Multiple choice)

Answer: into ... in

Explanation: translate into + a language (fixed); write in the box = inside the box (a space).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'translate in French' is wrong, and 'write into the box' overstates motion. (c) 'translate to French' is non-standard (translate into). (d) 'write on the box' = on its outer surface, not inside it.

Grammar principle: translate into + a language; write in a box/space (inside) vs on a surface (outside).

Memory tip: You translate a text into a language; you write inside a box.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Fixed 'into' + in vs on

Q63. (Multiple choice)

Answer: onto ... off

Explanation: stepped onto the ice from the bench = movement onto a surface; stepped off again = leaving the surface.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'stepped on the ice' tends to mean 'trod on it'; with 'from the bench' the entry movement is onto. (c) 'stepped from the ice' is odd. (d) reversed.

Grammar principle: onto = movement onto a surface; off = movement leaving a surface.

Memory tip: onto = getting on; off = getting off.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** onto vs off

Q64. (Rewrite (show movement))

Answer: For example: 'The dog ran out of the garden and into the kitchen.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Using 'in' for both shows position, not the movement between the two places.

Grammar principle: out of = movement leaving a space; into = movement entering a space.

Memory tip: Leaving a space -> out of; entering a space -> into.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Expressing movement with out of / into

Q65. (Error spotting)

Answer: 'walked into the bridge' should be 'walked onto the bridge' (or 'across the bridge'): 'He walked onto the bridge to cross the river.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: 'into the bridge' wrongly treats a bridge as something you enter; you step onto its surface / walk across it.

Grammar principle: onto/across for a surface such as a bridge; into for entering an enclosed space.

Memory tip: A bridge is a surface -> onto/across, not into.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** into vs onto with a bridge

Q66. (Dialogue completion)

Answer: up (these stairs) ... onto (the flat roof).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: 'go on these stairs' is wrong (should be up); 'step into the flat roof' is wrong (a roof is a surface -> onto, not into).

Grammar principle: up = ascending; onto = movement onto a surface.

Memory tip: up the stairs, onto the roof (a surface).

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** up + onto in context

Q67. (Context selection)

Answer: through ... past ... in

Explanation: through the narrow lanes = winding along enclosed lanes; past the town hall = going by it; in the main square = inside an open square.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'across the narrow lanes' loses the winding-along sense. (c) 'into the narrow lanes' = merely entering them. (d) 'passes into the town hall' = entering the building (wrong; the parade goes by it).

Grammar principle: through = amid/along enclosed lanes; past = going by without entering; in + an open square.

Memory tip: through the lanes, past the hall (not into it), in the square.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Combining movement prepositions

Section D - Verbs and Their Prepositions

Q68. (Multiple choice (choose the correct sentence))

Answer: Listen to me and I'll explain the plan to you.

Explanation: listen takes to before the person (listen to me); explain takes to before the person (explain something to someone), never 'explain someone'.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'listen me' drops to and 'explain you' drops to. (c) 'explain you the plan' - explain needs 'to' before the person. (d) 'listen me' - listen needs 'to'. These reflect dropping the preposition (a Hindi-influenced pattern).

Grammar principle: listen to someone; explain something to someone.

Memory tip: You always listen TO; you explain something TO a person.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** listen to / explain to (dropped prepositions)

Q69. (Multiple choice (choose the correct sentence))

Answer: The squad comprises eleven players.

Explanation: comprise takes NO 'of' - it already means 'be made up of'.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'comprises of' wrongly borrows the 'of' from 'consists of'/'composed of'. (c) 'is consisted of' - consist has no passive form. (d) 'consist' disagrees with the singular subject and 'consist of' is the correct verb - it should be 'consists of'.

Grammar principle: comprise (no of); consist of; be composed of - never 'comprise of' or 'is consisted of'.

Memory tip: 'comprise' already contains 'of' in its meaning - don't add it.

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** comprise vs consist of

Q70. (Explain the difference)

Answer: (i) believe you = I don't accept that what you are saying is true (I think you are mistaken or lying about this). (ii) believe in you = I don't have faith or confidence in you or your abilities. So (i) is about one statement; (ii) is about trust in the person overall.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: assuming the 'in' is optional or decorative. It changes the meaning completely.

Grammar principle: believe someone = accept their statement; believe in someone = trust / have faith in them.

Memory tip: believe you = 'I trust this statement'; believe in you = 'I trust who you are'.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Meaning shift with a dependent preposition

Q71. (Multiple choice)

Answer: with ... to

Explanation: agree with a person/opinion = share it; agree to a proposal/plan = consent to it. Because he 'still disliked it', he could only consent (agree to), not share the opinion.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'agree to you' is wrong, and 'agree with their decision' contradicts 'still disliked it'. (c) 'agree with their decision' contradicts disliking it (you can't share an opinion you dislike). (d) 'agree on you' is wrong (agree on = settle a matter jointly).

Grammar principle: agree with a person/opinion (share it); agree to a proposal (consent); agree on a matter (settle it together).

Memory tip: with = same opinion; to = say yes to a plan; on = settle a matter together.

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** agree with / to / on

Q72. (Multiple choice)

Answer: to ... to

Explanation: belong to someone = be owned by that person.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'belong with' means 'go together with' (not ownership). (c) 'belong with me' would mean 'go together with me', not 'be owned by me'. (d) dropping 'to' after belong is wrong.

Grammar principle: belong to someone = be owned by; belong with = go together with.

Memory tip: Ownership -> belong to.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** belong to

Q73. (Multiple choice)

Answer: look after ... looks for

Explanation: look after = take care of (the children); look for = search for (a job).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swapped: 'look for the children' = search for them; 'looks after a new job' = takes care of a job. (c) 'look at the children' = merely watch them. (d) 'looks at a new job' = examines one job, not searching.

Grammar principle: look after = take care of; look for = search for; look at = direct your eyes at.

Memory tip: after = care for; for = search; at = point your eyes.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** look after / for / at

Q74. (Sentence correction)

Answer: 'requested for a glass of water' should be 'requested a glass of water' (request is transitive - no 'for'). 'asked for the time' is correct. Corrected: 'He requested a glass of water and asked for the time.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Adding 'for' after request is a common Indian-English error; request takes a direct object, unlike 'ask for'.

Grammar principle: request + object (no for); ask for + object.

Memory tip: You request something, but you ask for something.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** request (no for) vs ask for

Q75. (Multiple choice)

Answer: to ... for

Explanation: apologise to + the person, for + the offence.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'apologise with' is wrong. (c) 'apologise of' is wrong. (d) reversed order and prepositions.

Grammar principle: apologise to + person, for + the thing done.

Memory tip: You say sorry TO a person FOR a deed.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** apologise to / for

Q76. (Multiple choice)

Answer: from

Explanation: prevent someone/something from + gerund.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'prevented to take place' is a calque (prevent to do). (c) 'prevent of' is wrong. (d) 'prevent for' is wrong.

Grammar principle: prevent / stop / keep someone from doing something (+ -ing).

Memory tip: prevent FROM doing - it blocks the action.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** prevent from + -ing

Q77. (Multiple choice)

Answer: to ... about

Explanation: complain to + the person you tell; complain about + the problem.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) reverses the roles and makes nonsense. (c) 'complain with' is wrong. (d) 'complain of' is for a symptom/ailment ('complain of a headache'), not a service you report.

Grammar principle: complain to + person; complain about + thing; complain of + a symptom.

Memory tip: You complain TO a person ABOUT a problem.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** complain to / about / of

Q78. (Multiple choice)

Answer: at ... in

Explanation: arrive at + a place/building (airport); arrive in + a city (Delhi).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swapped. (c) 'arrive at Delhi' - a city takes in. (d) 'arrive to' is a calque; arrive never takes 'to'.

Grammar principle: arrive at + a point/building/small place; arrive in + a town/country; never 'arrive to'.

Memory tip: at a spot, in a big place; never 'arrive to'.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** arrive at / in (and no 'arrive to')

Q79. (Multiple choice)

Answer: for

Explanation: search for = try to find (someone/something). (Note: 'search a place' - transitive - means look through it: 'searched the cave for treasure'.)

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'searched the missing hikers' would mean searching the hikers' bodies. (c) 'search about' is wrong. (d) 'search to' is wrong.

Grammar principle: search for + what you want to find; search + a place you look through.

Memory tip: search FOR the thing you want; search a place you rummage through.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** search for

Q80. (Multiple choice)

Answer: from

Explanation: suffer from + a named illness/condition.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'suffer of' is a calque. (c) 'suffer with' is colloquial for enduring an ache, but the standard with a named condition is 'suffer from'. (d) 'suffer arthritis' - suffer is transitive only for events ('suffer a defeat'), not illnesses.

Grammar principle: suffer from + an illness/condition.

Memory tip: For an illness, you suffer FROM it.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** suffer from

Q81. (Multiple choice)

Answer: at

Explanation: laugh at someone = mock/ridicule them.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'laugh on' is a calque. (c) 'laugh of' is wrong. (d) 'laugh with' means share friendly laughter, not mock a mistake.

Grammar principle: laugh at = mock; laugh with = share amusement.

Memory tip: Mocking -> laugh AT; sharing -> laugh WITH.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** laugh at vs with

Q82. (Multiple choice)

Answer: in

Explanation: participate in + an activity/event.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'participate at' is wrong. (c) 'participate on' is wrong. (d) 'participate to' is a French calque ('participer a').

Grammar principle: participate in + an activity/event.

Memory tip: You take part IN something.

Difficulty: 4/10 | **Cognitive skill:** participate in

Q83. (Multiple choice)

Answer: on

Explanation: insist on + noun/gerund.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'insisted to pay' is a calque. (c) 'insist in' is wrong. (d) 'insist for' is wrong.

Grammar principle: insist on + noun/gerund.

Memory tip: insist ON doing.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** insist on + -ing

Q84. (Multiple choice)

Answer: to

Explanation: object to + noun/gerund. Because 'to' here is a preposition, a gerund follows ('opening'), not an infinitive.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'object against' is redundant (object already means 'be against'). (c) 'object on' is wrong. (d) 'object for' is wrong.

Grammar principle: object to + noun/gerund (the 'to' is a preposition -> -ing).

Memory tip: object TO something; and 'object to opening', not 'object to open'.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** object to + -ing (the 'to' trap)

Q85. (Multiple choice)

Answer: to seeing

Explanation: In 'look forward to', 'to' is a preposition, so it is followed by the -ing form (seeing).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'look forward to see' is the classic error - treating 'to' as an infinitive marker. (c) 'look forward for' is wrong. (d) 'look forward at' is wrong.

Grammar principle: In 'look forward to', 'to' is a preposition -> followed by -ing, not the base verb.

Memory tip: You can 'look forward to it' - so 'to' is a preposition -> 'look forward to seeing'.

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** 'to' as a preposition (look forward to + -ing)

Q86. (Choose ALL correct)

Answer: (a), (c) and (d) are correct; (b) is wrong.

Explanation: 'be used to', 'confess to' and 'resort to' all have 'to' as a preposition, so a gerund follows: 'used to waking', 'confessed to taking', 'resorted to cheating'.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'is used to wake up early' is wrong: 'be used to' (accustomed) needs -ing. The base-verb pattern belongs to a different structure, 'used to + base verb' (a past habit), which does not fit 'She is used to ___'.

Grammar principle: 'be/get used to', 'confess to', 'resort to', 'object to', 'look forward to' all take -ing.

Memory tip: If you can replace the noun after 'to' with 'it', 'to' is a preposition -> use -ing.

Difficulty: 9/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Distinguishing preposition-'to' from infinitive-'to'

Q87. (Sentence correction)

Answer: 'discuss about the project' should be 'discuss the project' (discuss is transitive - no 'about'). Corrected: 'Let's discuss the project during lunch.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Adding 'about' after discuss is a common Indian-English error; discuss, mention and describe take a direct object.

Grammar principle: discuss + object (no about).

Memory tip: You discuss something, not 'discuss about' it. (Compare: 'talk about'.)

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** discuss (no about)

Q88. (Sentence correction)

Answer: 'entered into the hall' should be 'entered the hall' (enter a place is transitive; 'enter into' is only for abstract things such as agreements). Corrected: 'The students entered the hall quietly.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Adding 'into' after enter for a physical place is the error; 'enter into' is reserved for agreements, contracts and discussions.

Grammar principle: enter + a place (no into); enter into + an agreement/discussion.

Memory tip: You enter a room, but you enter into a deal.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** enter (no into) vs enter into

Q89. (Sentence correction)

Answer: 'return back' should be 'return' (return already means 'give/go back', so 'back' is redundant). Corrected: 'Please return the library book by Friday.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Adding 'back' after return is redundant (like 'repeat again', 'revert back').

Grammar principle: return = give/go back; do not add 'back'.

Memory tip: 'return' already contains 'back' - don't say it twice.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Redundant 'back' with return

Q90. (Multiple choice)

Answer: of ... for

Explanation: accuse someone of (doing) something; blame someone for something.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swapped: 'accuse for' and 'blame of' are both wrong. (c) 'blame of' is wrong. (d) 'accuse with' is wrong.

Grammar principle: accuse of; blame for (but note 'blame something on someone').

Memory tip: accuse OF a wrong; blame FOR a result.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** accuse of vs blame for

Q91. (Multiple choice)

Answer: on ... of

Explanation: congratulate someone on something; remind someone of something = make them recall it.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'congratulate for' is a common error (standard is 'on'), and 'remind about' is for prompting about a task, not triggering a memory. (c) 'remind about my first prize' would mean 'prompt me to deal with it'; here the sense is 'brings the memory back' -> of. (d) 'congratulate for' is the error.

Grammar principle: congratulate on; remind of (trigger a memory) vs remind about (prompt about a task).

Memory tip: congratulate ON an achievement; something reminds you OF a memory.

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** congratulate on / remind of vs about

Q92. (Error spotting)

Answer: 'married with a doctor' should be 'married a doctor' (marry is transitive - no 'with'). You may also say 'She got married to a doctor.' Corrected: 'She married a doctor she met at college.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: 'marry with' is a calque (from Hindi/Spanish); marry takes a direct object, or use 'be/get married to someone'.

Grammar principle: marry someone (no with); be married TO someone.

Memory tip: You marry someone, or are married TO them - never 'married with'.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** marry (no with) / married to

Q93. (Dialogue completion)

Answer: to (the whole team) ... on (finishing the report).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: 'explain the whole team' is wrong (needs 'to'); 'congratulated me for' is non-standard (use 'on').

Grammar principle: explain something to someone; congratulate someone on something.

Memory tip: explain TO people; congratulate ON an achievement.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** explain to / congratulate on in context

Section E - Adjectives and Their Prepositions

Q94. (Multiple choice)

Answer: at ... at

Explanation: good at / bad at + a skill, subject or activity.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'good in mathematics' is a calque; standard English uses 'good at' for a skill. (c) 'bad in spelling' is wrong. (d) 'good with' is for handling things or people ('good with children'), not a subject.

Grammar principle: good/bad at + a skill/subject/activity; good with + tools/people you handle.

Memory tip: You're good AT a skill; good WITH people or things.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** good at vs good with

Q95. (Multiple choice)

Answer: in ... by

Explanation: interested in + a topic; fascinated by (or with) something.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'fascinated in' is wrong. (c) 'interested about' is wrong. (d) 'interested on' is wrong.

Grammar principle: interested in; fascinated by/with.

Memory tip: interested IN a topic; fascinated BY something amazing.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** interested in / fascinated by

Q96. (Multiple choice)

Answer: of ... of

Explanation: afraid of / scared of / frightened of.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b)/(c) 'afraid/scared from' is a calque (from Hindi 'se darna'). (d) 'afraid with' is wrong.

Grammar principle: afraid of / scared of / frightened of.

Memory tip: Fear takes OF, not 'from'.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** afraid/scared of (not 'from')

Q97. (Multiple choice)

Answer: of ... for

Explanation: proud of + someone/something; responsible for + a duty/result.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swapped. (c) 'responsible of' is wrong. (d) 'proud about' is colloquial; standard is 'proud of'.

Grammar principle: proud of + someone/something; responsible for + a duty/result.

Memory tip: proud OF; responsible FOR.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** proud of / responsible for

Q98. (Multiple choice)

Answer: from ... to

Explanation: different from; similar to.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'different than' is accepted in some US speech, but formal/SAT English prefers 'different from'. (c) 'different to' is BrE colloquial, and 'similar from' is wrong. (d) 'similar from' is wrong.

Grammar principle: different from; similar to; identical to.

Memory tip: different FROM; similar/identical TO.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** different from / similar to

Q99. (Multiple choice)

Answer: with ... about

Explanation: angry with + a person; angry about + a thing or situation. ('Angry at a person' is common in American English, but the mistake still takes 'about', not 'with'.)

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'angry with their mistakes' is wrong (a thing takes about/at, not with). (c) 'angry about the players' treats people as a situation. (d) 'angry with their mistakes' - mistakes take about, not with.

Grammar principle: angry with + a person; angry about + a thing/situation.

Memory tip: angry WITH a person; angry ABOUT a thing.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** angry with vs about (person vs thing)

Q100. (Multiple choice)

Answer: for ... for

Explanation: famous for / known for + the quality or product it is celebrated for.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'famous as' = famous in the role of ('famous as a singer'), not for a product. (c) 'known as' = called/named, a different meaning. (d) 'famous by' is wrong.

Grammar principle: famous/known for + a quality or product; famous/known as + a role or name.

Memory tip: for a quality; as a role/name.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** famous for vs famous as

Q101. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) as = in her role/capacity - she is well known in the role of a poet. (ii) for = because of the thing that made her famous - her poems. So (i) names what she is; (ii) names what she is celebrated for.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: swapping as (role) and for (reason).

Grammar principle: famous as + a role; famous for + the reason/quality.

Memory tip: as = the hat she wears; for = the reason people know her.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** as (role) vs for (reason)

Q102. (Multiple choice)

Answer: of

Explanation: tired of = bored / fed up with. (Note: 'tired from' means physically exhausted by an effort - 'tired from running'.)

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'tired from' means worn out by an activity; here the sense is 'fed up', so 'of'. (c) 'tired with' is non-standard here. (d) 'tired by' is wrong.

Grammar principle: tired of = fed up with; tired from = exhausted by an effort.

Memory tip: Fed up -> tired OF; worn out -> tired FROM.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** tired of vs tired from

Q103. (Are both acceptable?)

Answer: Yes - both are correct. 'surprised by' slightly emphasises the news as the cause/agent that produced the surprise; 'surprised at' slightly emphasises your reaction to it. In everyday use they are interchangeable here.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Errors: thinking only one is allowed; or using 'surprised of'/'surprised from' (both wrong).

Grammar principle: surprised at / surprised by are both standard; 'surprised of/from' are not.

Memory tip: by = what caused it; at = your reaction - both fine; never 'of/from'.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Recognising acceptable variants (at/by)

Q104. (Multiple choice)

Answer: with ... about

Explanation: pleased with + something you produced; worried about + a concern.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swapped. (c) 'worried with' is wrong. (d) 'pleased at' occurs with an event ('pleased at the result'), but with a thing you made 'pleased with' is standard; the second blank still needs 'about'.

Grammar principle: pleased with + someone/something; worried about + a concern.

Memory tip: pleased WITH; worried ABOUT.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** pleased with / worried about

Q105. (Multiple choice)

Answer: of ... for ... for

Explanation: capable of; suitable for; ready for + a noun.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'capable for' and 'suitable of' are wrong. (c) 'suitable to' is less standard than 'suitable for'. (d) 'ready to' takes a verb ('ready to face'), not a noun; before a noun it is 'ready for'.

Grammar principle: capable of; suitable for; ready for + noun (but ready to + verb).

Memory tip: capable OF; suitable/ready FOR a thing.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** capable of / suitable for / ready for

Q106. (Multiple choice)

Answer: of ... of

Explanation: aware of; fond of.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'aware about' is wrong. (c) 'fond for' is wrong. (d) 'aware with' is wrong.

Grammar principle: aware of; fond of.

Memory tip: aware OF; fond OF.

Difficulty: 4/10 | **Cognitive skill:** aware of / fond of

Q107. (Sentence correction)

Answer: 'keen in football' should be 'keen on football'; 'good in defending' should be 'good at defending'. Corrected: 'He is very keen on football and good at defending.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Errors: 'keen in' (should be keen on + noun) and 'good in' an activity (should be good at).

Grammar principle: keen on + noun; good at + activity/skill.

Memory tip: keen ON; good AT an activity.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** keen on / good at

Q108. (Multiple choice)

Answer: on ... of

Explanation: dependent on; independent of.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swapped. (c) 'independent from' is a calque; standard is 'independent of'. (d) 'independent to' is wrong.

Grammar principle: dependent on; independent of.

Memory tip: dependent ON (leaning on); independent OF (free of).

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** dependent on vs independent of

Q109. (Multiple choice)

Answer: to ... to

Explanation: superior to; prefer X to Y. Both take 'to', never 'than'.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b)/(c) 'superior than' and 'prefer than' are errors by false analogy with comparatives like 'better than'. (d) 'superior from' is wrong.

Grammar principle: superior/inferior/senior/junior/prior to; prefer X to Y - all take 'to', not 'than'.

Memory tip: These Latin-based words take TO, not 'than'.

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** superior to / prefer to (not 'than')

Q110. (Multiple choice)

Answer: of ... from ... with

Explanation: made of solid oak (material still recognisable); made from wood pulp (material transformed into something new); made with real butter (one ingredient among others).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b)/(c)/(d) swap the three: 'made from oak' misses that the oak is still visibly oak; 'made of wood pulp' misses the transformation into paper; 'made of butter' would mean the cake is entirely butter.

Grammar principle: made of = material still recognisable; made from = material transformed; made with = one ingredient used.

Memory tip: of = you can still see it; from = it became something new; with = one ingredient in the mix.

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** made of / from / with

Q111. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) made from = the original material (grapes) has been transformed and is no longer recognisable in the product. (ii) made of = the material (glass) is still present and recognisable in the finished object. So 'from' signals a transformation; 'of' signals the material is unchanged.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: using 'of' when the material has changed form, or 'from' when it has not.

Grammar principle: made of = unchanged material; made from = transformed material.

Memory tip: If you can still 'see' the material, use of; if it turned into something new, use from.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Transformation vs unchanged material

Q112. (Choose ALL correct)

Answer: (a), (b) and (d) are correct; (c) is wrong.

Explanation: married to, allergic to and jealous of are the standard combinations.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (c) 'guilty for' is wrong - it should be 'guilty of the crime'. (Note the near neighbour 'responsible for' does take 'for', which makes 'guilty for' tempting.)

Grammar principle: married to; allergic to; jealous of; guilty of.

Memory tip: guilty OF a crime, not 'for'.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Fixed adjective + preposition set

Q113. (Multiple choice)

Answer: to ... for

Explanation: grateful to + the person, for + the thing.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swapped. (c) 'grateful with' is wrong. (d) 'grateful of' is wrong.

Grammar principle: grateful/thankful to + person, for + the thing.

Memory tip: grateful TO a person FOR a favour.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** grateful to / for

Q114. (Error spotting)

Answer: 'consistent to' should be 'consistent with'; 'similar with' should be 'similar to'. Corrected: 'The results were consistent with our earlier findings and similar to last year's.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: consistent takes 'with' (not 'to'); similar takes 'to' (not 'with'). They are easy to swap.

Grammar principle: consistent with; similar to.

Memory tip: consistent WITH; similar TO - don't cross them.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** consistent with / similar to

Q115. (Multiple choice)

Answer: about ... at ... on

Explanation: anxious about (worried); bad at + an activity; keen on + a noun.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'anxious for' means eagerly wanting ('anxious for news'), and 'bad in' is wrong. (c) 'bad in' is wrong. (d) 'anxious of' is wrong.

Grammar principle: anxious about (worried) vs anxious for (eager); bad at + activity; keen on + noun.

Memory tip: worried -> anxious ABOUT; skill -> bad AT; enthusiasm -> keen ON.

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** anxious about/for, bad at, keen on

Section F - Unnecessary, Wrong, Missing or Correct

Q116. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Unnecessary preposition. 'emphasised on' should be 'emphasised' (emphasise is transitive - it takes a direct object). Corrected: 'The principal emphasised the need for discipline.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: The noun phrase 'put emphasis ON' misleads people into adding 'on' to the verb; the verb 'emphasise' takes no preposition.

Grammar principle: emphasise + object (no on); but 'lay/put emphasis on'.

Memory tip: The verb emphasises something directly - drop the 'on'.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Unnecessary preposition (emphasise on)

Q117. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Correct - no change needed. 'reply to' is right: reply is intransitive and needs 'to' before the thing replied to.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: The trap is 'correcting' a sentence that is already right (or dropping 'to' to make 'reply my email', which is wrong).

Grammar principle: reply to + something/someone (but 'answer' takes no 'to': answer the email).

Memory tip: You reply TO a message, but you answer it (no 'to').

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Recognising a correct sentence (reply to)

Q118. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Unnecessary word. 'cope up with' should be 'cope with' ('up' is redundant). Corrected: 'He could not cope with the pressure.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: 'cope up with' is a common calque; the correct phrasal verb is just 'cope with'.

Grammar principle: cope with + a difficulty (no 'up').

Memory tip: You cope WITH something - there is no 'up' in it.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Unnecessary 'up' (cope up with)

Q119. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Unnecessary preposition. 'resembles to' should be 'resembles' (resemble is transitive). Corrected: 'The child resembles his father.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: By analogy with 'similar to', people wrongly add 'to'; resemble takes a direct object.

Grammar principle: resemble + object (no to); compare 'bears a resemblance to'.

Memory tip: You resemble someone directly - drop the 'to'.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Unnecessary 'to' (resemble to)

Q120. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Unnecessary preposition. 'reached to the station' should be 'reached the station' (reach a place is transitive). Corrected: 'We reached the station just in time.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: People add 'to' by analogy with 'got to/arrived at'; reach takes the place as a direct object.

Grammar principle: reach + a place/level (no to): 'reach the top', 'reach the station'.

Memory tip: You reach a place directly - no 'to'.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Unnecessary 'to' (reach to)

Q121. (Multiple choice (choose the correct sentence))

Answer: She explained the rules to the new players.

Explanation: explain + something + to + someone. You cannot 'explain someone something', and no 'about' is needed.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'explain someone something' uses a double object, which explain does not allow. (c) 'explain about' adds an unnecessary 'about'. (d) 'explain ... with' is wrong - it should be 'to'.

Grammar principle: explain something to someone (no double object, no 'about').

Memory tip: explain the thing TO the person.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** explain something to someone

Q122. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Needed and correct. 'look into' is a phrasal verb meaning 'investigate'; the 'into' is essential and cannot be dropped.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: The trap is deleting 'into' as if it were redundant; 'look the matter' is meaningless, and 'look at the matter' changes the sense to 'view' rather than 'investigate'.

Grammar principle: look into = investigate (the particle carries the meaning).

Memory tip: look INTO = dig into / investigate.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Recognising a needed particle (look into)

Q123. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Correct - no change needed. 'discuss' correctly takes a direct object (no 'about'), and 'vote for' is the right combination.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: The trap is adding 'about' after discuss, or changing 'vote for'. Both are already correct here.

Grammar principle: discuss + object (no about); vote for + something.

Memory tip: discuss it directly; vote FOR it.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Recognising a correct sentence

Q124. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Wrong preposition/structure. 'interested to join' should be 'interested in joining' (interested in + gerund). Corrected: 'She is not interested in joining the club.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: 'interested to + verb' is used only with a few verbs of reaction ('interested to hear/know'); to talk about an activity you want to do, use 'interested in + -ing'.

Grammar principle: interested in + noun/gerund.

Memory tip: interested IN doing something.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** interested in + -ing (not 'interested to')

Q125. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Missing preposition. It should be 'listen to the instructions'. Corrected: 'Please listen to the instructions carefully.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Dropping 'to' after listen is a common error; listen is intransitive and needs 'to' before its object.

Grammar principle: listen to + something/someone.

Memory tip: You listen TO something.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Missing 'to' (listen to)

Q126. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Missing preposition. It should be 'depend on the weather'. Corrected: 'The results depend on the weather.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Dropping 'on' leaves depend without its required preposition.

Grammar principle: depend on + something.

Memory tip: You depend ON something.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Missing 'on' (depend on)

Q127. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Wrong preposition. 'divide in' should be 'divide into' (divide something into parts). Corrected: 'Divide this cake into four pieces.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: 'in' suggests location; splitting something into parts needs 'into' (showing the result of the division).

Grammar principle: divide/split/cut something into + parts.

Memory tip: Breaking into parts -> into, not in.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** divide into (not 'divide in')

Q128. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Correct - no change needed. 'congratulations on + something' is the standard combination.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: The trap is changing 'on' to 'for'; congratulations/congratulate take 'on'.

Grammar principle: congratulations on / congratulate someone on + an achievement.

Memory tip: congratulate ON an achievement.

Difficulty: 4/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Recognising correct 'congratulations on'

Q129. (Classify the use)

Answer: Acceptable, but it changes the meaning. 'on the roof' is grammatical and means the ball ended up resting on the roof. If you mean the action of landing it up there, 'onto the roof' is clearer; if it went right over, 'over the roof'. So 'on' is not an error - it just fixes the ball on the roof rather than stressing the movement.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: The trap is calling it simply 'right' or 'wrong'; the honest answer is that the preposition is acceptable but shifts the meaning (resting-position vs movement).

Grammar principle: on = resting position; onto = movement onto a surface; over = across the top.

Memory tip: on = it sits there; onto = it lands there; over = it clears it.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Classifying acceptable-but-different-meaning

Q130. (Multiple choice (choose the correct sentence))

Answer: He applied for leave.

Explanation: apply takes 'for' (apply for leave/a job). request, demand and order are transitive verbs and take no 'for'.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (a) 'requested for' -> request (no for). (c) 'demanded for' -> demand (no for). (d) 'ordered for' -> order (no for).

Grammar principle: apply for + something; but request/demand/order + object (no 'for').

Memory tip: You apply FOR leave, but you request/demand it directly.

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** apply for vs request/demand/order (no 'for')

Q131. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Non-standard structure. Standard English is 'asked the class a question' (ask + someone + something), or 'put a question to the class'. Corrected: 'The teacher asked the class a question.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: 'ask a question to someone' is often heard but is non-standard; ask takes two objects (someone + something).

Grammar principle: ask someone something; or put a question to someone.

Memory tip: You ask the class a question - not 'ask a question to the class'.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** ask someone a question (structure)

Q132. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Missing preposition. It should be 'look forward to your reply'. Corrected: 'I look forward to your reply.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: The 'to' in 'look forward to' is easily dropped; here it is followed by a noun ('your reply'), so no -ing is involved.

Grammar principle: look forward to + a noun (or -ing).

Memory tip: You look forward TO something.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Missing 'to' (look forward to + noun)

Q133. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Wrong preposition. 'angry on' should be 'angry with me' (or 'angry at me' in American English). Corrected: 'He is angry with me.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: 'angry on' is a calque; a person takes 'with' (traditionally) or 'at' (American English), never 'on'.

Grammar principle: angry with / at + a person (not 'on').

Memory tip: You're angry WITH a person, not 'on' them.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** angry with/at (not 'angry on')

Q134. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Correct - no change needed. 'accuse someone of + (doing) something' is the standard combination.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: The trap is changing 'of' to 'for'; accuse takes 'of' (blame takes 'for').

Grammar principle: accuse someone of + a wrong; blame someone for + a result.

Memory tip: accuse OF; blame FOR.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Recognising correct 'accuse of'

Q135. (Choose ALL that are wrong)

Answer: (a) and (c) are wrong; (b) and (d) are correct.

Explanation: (a) 'good in cooking' should be 'good at cooking'. (c) 'discussed about' should be 'discussed' (no 'about').

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'interested in' and (d) 'fond of' are already correct, so selecting them would be a mistake.

Grammar principle: good at + activity; discuss + object (no about); interested in; fond of.

Memory tip: good AT, discuss it directly; interested IN, fond OF.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Identifying multiple errors among correct sentences

Q136. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Wrong structure. It should be 'explain this sum to me' (explain something to someone). Corrected: 'Can you explain this sum to me?'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: 'explain me' treats explain like 'tell/give' (which allow 'me' directly); explain needs 'to' before the person.

Grammar principle: explain something to someone (not 'explain me something').

Memory tip: explain the sum TO me.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** explain something to someone (not 'explain me')

Q137. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Wrong preposition. 'effect to' should be 'effect on' (have an effect on someone/something). Corrected: 'The medicine had no effect on the patient.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: By analogy with 'do something to', people write 'effect to'; the fixed phrase is 'an effect on'.

Grammar principle: have an effect on + someone/something.

Memory tip: An effect works ON its target.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** effect on (not 'effect to')

Q138. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Correct - no change needed. Ending with 'about' is perfectly acceptable here; the stiff alternative 'the book about which I told you' is not required in modern English.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: The trap is the myth that a sentence may never end with a preposition; here the preposition naturally falls at the end and the sentence is standard.

Grammar principle: A sentence may end with a preposition when the phrasing is natural ('told you about').

Memory tip: 'Never end a sentence with a preposition' is a myth - this is fine.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Debunking 'never end with a preposition'

Q139. (Multiple choice (choose the correct sentence))

Answer: They are keen on hiking.

Explanation: 'keen on + noun/-ing' is correct. The others add an unnecessary preposition.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (a) 'married with' -> married (to). (b) 'resembles to' -> resembles. (d) 'reached to' -> reached.

Grammar principle: keen on + activity; marry someone; resemble someone; reach a place.

Memory tip: keen ON; but marry/resemble/reach take their object directly.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Identifying the single correct preposition use

Section G - Prepositional Phrases

Q140. (Multiple choice)

Answer: In spite of ... Despite

Explanation: in spite of and despite mean the same, but despite takes NO 'of'.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'Despite of' is wrong, and 'In spite' without 'of' is incomplete. (c) 'Despite of' is wrong. (d) 'Although' is a conjunction and needs a clause ('although they were tired'), not a noun phrase.

Grammar principle: in spite of + noun/gerund; despite + noun/gerund (no 'of'); although + a clause.

Memory tip: 'despite' already includes the 'of' meaning - never say 'despite of'.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** in spite of vs despite (no 'of')

Q141. (Multiple choice)

Answer: because of ... due to

Explanation: Traditionally, 'because of' modifies the verb ('was cancelled because of the storm'), while 'due to' attaches to a noun through 'be' ('the cancellation was due to safety concerns'). Modern usage often blurs this.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) reversed: traditionally 'due to' should not modify the verb 'cancelled', and 'the cancellation was because of' is the looser half. (c) 'the cancellation was because of' is accepted in modern usage but not the crisp traditional pairing. (d) 'owing to' works like 'because of' (adverbial), leaving 'was because of' as the loose half.

Grammar principle: Traditionally: 'due to' follows a noun/'be' (a delay due to fog); 'because of'/'owing to' modify a verb (delayed because of fog).

Memory tip: 'the X was due to...' (attaches to a noun); 'happened because of...' (attaches to a verb).

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** due to vs because of (traditional distinction)

Q142. (Multiple choice)

Answer: Instead of ... instead of

Explanation: instead of + noun/gerund (complaining; coffee).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'Instead complaining' drops 'of'. (c) 'In spite of complaining' changes the meaning. (d) 'instead coffee' drops 'of'. Note 'instead' alone is an adverb ('I'll have tea instead').

Grammar principle: instead of + noun/gerund; instead (alone) = an adverb at the end.

Memory tip: Before a noun -> 'instead of'; standing alone -> 'instead'.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** instead of vs instead

Q143. (Multiple choice)

Answer: According to

Explanation: according to + a source.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'According' alone is incomplete. (c) 'As per to' is wrong ('as per' takes no 'to' and is jargon). (d) 'according with' is wrong.

Grammar principle: according to + a source (but never 'according to me' - use 'in my opinion').

Memory tip: according TO a source; but 'in my opinion', never 'according to me'.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** according to

Q144. (Multiple choice)

Answer: on behalf of

Explanation: on behalf of = representing / for someone.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'on behalf to' is wrong. (c) 'in behalf to' is wrong. (d) 'on the behalf' drops 'of'.

Grammar principle: on behalf of + someone (representing them).

Memory tip: You act ON BEHALF OF the people you represent.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** on behalf of

Q145. (Multiple choice)

Answer: with regard to

Explanation: with regard to (singular 'regard') = concerning. 'regarding' and 'as regards' are also correct.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'with regards to' is non-standard - 'regards' (plural) is for greetings ('give my regards'). (c) 'in regards to' is non-standard. (d) 'with regard of' is wrong.

Grammar principle: with regard to / in regard to / as regards / regarding; 'regards' only for greetings.

Memory tip: The linking phrase uses singular 'regard'; save 'regards' for 'best regards'.

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** with regard to (not 'with regards to')

Q146. (Multiple choice)

Answer: In addition to

Explanation: in addition to + noun/gerund.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'In addition' needs a comma + clause ('In addition, he earns...'), not a noun directly. (c) 'Additional to' is wrong. (d) 'In addition of' is wrong.

Grammar principle: in addition to + noun/gerund; 'in addition' (alone) links clauses.

Memory tip: Before a noun -> 'in addition to'; as a connector -> 'in addition,'.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** in addition to

Q147. (Multiple choice)

Answer: by means of

Explanation: by means of = using (a method or instrument).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'by means to' is wrong. (c) 'with means of' is wrong. (d) 'by mean of' (singular) is wrong.

Grammar principle: by means of + a method/instrument.

Memory tip: by MEANS of = by using.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** by means of

Q148. (Multiple choice)

Answer: in favour of ... in charge of

Explanation: in favour of = supporting; in charge of = responsible for / managing.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'in favour to' and 'in charge for' are wrong. (c) 'in charge for' is wrong. (d) 'in the favour of' is wrong.

Grammar principle: in favour of + something; in charge of + something/someone.

Memory tip: IN FAVOUR OF what you support; IN CHARGE OF what you manage.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** in favour of / in charge of

Q149. (Multiple choice)

Answer: In case of

Explanation: in case of + noun = if there is (a fire).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'In case' needs a clause ('in case a fire starts'), not a noun directly. (c) 'In the case' shifts the meaning. (d) 'In case for' is wrong.

Grammar principle: in case of + noun (= if X happens); in case + clause (as a precaution).

Memory tip: 'In case of fire' = if there is a fire.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** in case of + noun

Q150. (Explain the difference)

Answer: Both are correct and mean nearly the same. (i) 'in case of + noun' (rain) and (ii) 'in case + clause' (it rains) both express a precaution against rain. The only difference is grammatical: 'in case of' is followed by a noun, 'in case' by subject + verb. Note 'in case' here means 'as a precaution', not 'if'.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Errors: writing 'in case of it rains' (mixing the two), or reading 'in case' as 'if'.

Grammar principle: in case of + noun; in case + clause (precaution).

Memory tip: Follow 'in case of' with a thing, 'in case' with a mini-sentence.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** in case of vs in case

Q151. (Multiple choice)

Answer: Apart from

Explanation: apart from + noun = except for / besides.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'Apart of' is wrong. (c) 'Apart to' is wrong. (d) 'Apart' alone is an adverb ('they drifted apart') and cannot take a noun directly.

Grammar principle: apart from + noun (= except for / in addition to).

Memory tip: 'Apart from X' = leaving X aside.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** apart from

Q152. (Multiple choice)

Answer: in comparison with

Explanation: in comparison with (or 'in comparison to') = compared with.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'in comparison than' is wrong. (c) 'in comparison of' is wrong. (d) 'comparison to' drops 'in'.

Grammar principle: in comparison with/to + something; compared with/to.

Memory tip: Compare one thing WITH/TO another.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** in comparison with/to

Q153. (Sentence correction)

Answer: 'Inspite of' is not one word; it should be three words: 'In spite of'. Corrected: 'In spite of the traffic, we arrived on time.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Writing 'inspite' as a single word is a very common spelling error; the phrase is 'in spite of'.

Grammar principle: in spite of = three separate words.

Memory tip: It's IN SPITE OF - three words, not 'inspite'.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Form of 'in spite of'

Q154. (Sentence correction)

Answer: 'in spite of she was unwell' is wrong - 'in spite of' takes a noun or gerund, not a clause. Use 'in spite of being unwell' (or 'although she was unwell'). Corrected: 'She passed the test in spite of being unwell.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: 'in spite of' cannot be followed by a subject + verb; either turn the verb into '-ing' or switch to the conjunction 'although'.

Grammar principle: in spite of + noun/gerund; although + clause.

Memory tip: After 'in spite of', use 'being', not 'she was'.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** in spite of + gerund (not a clause)

Q155. (Multiple choice)

Answer: Despite

Explanation: despite + gerund (working).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'Despite of' is wrong. (c) 'Although' needs a clause ('although he worked hard'), not '-ing' directly. (d) 'In spite' drops 'of'.

Grammar principle: despite / in spite of + noun/gerund; although + clause.

Memory tip: 'Despite working' (no 'of'); 'although he worked'.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** despite + -ing

Q156. (Choose ALL correct)

Answer: (a) and (c) are correct; (b) and (d) are wrong.

Explanation: 'Despite the rain' and 'In spite of the rain' both correctly take the noun 'the rain'.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'Despite of' is wrong (despite takes no 'of'). (d) 'Although the rain' is wrong - although needs a clause ('although it was raining').

Grammar principle: despite + noun; in spite of + noun; although + clause.

Memory tip: despite/in spite of take a noun; although takes a full clause.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Correct concessive phrases

Q157. (Multiple choice)

Answer: on behalf of ... in favour of ... in charge of

Explanation: on behalf of the residents (representing them); in favour of the new park (supporting it); in charge of the committee (managing it).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b)/(c)/(d) swap the phrases so they no longer match the meanings 'representing', 'supporting' and 'managing'.

Grammar principle: on behalf of = representing; in favour of = supporting; in charge of = managing.

Memory tip: represent -> on behalf of; support -> in favour of; manage -> in charge of.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Matching prepositional phrases to meaning

Q158. (Multiple choice)

Answer: With regard to ... regardless of

Explanation: with regard to your question (concerning it); regardless of the cost (no matter the cost).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) reverses the meanings. (c) 'With regards to' (plural) is non-standard. (d) 'regardless to' is wrong - it is 'regardless of'.

Grammar principle: with regard to = concerning; regardless of = no matter (never 'regardless to').

Memory tip: concerning -> with regard to; no matter what -> regardless of.

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** with regard to vs regardless of

Q159. (Multiple choice)

Answer: by means of ... in case of ... in addition to

Explanation: by means of a keypad (using it); in case of a power cut (if there is one); in addition to that (as well as).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b)/(c)/(d) swap the phrases so the meanings 'method', 'precaution' and 'addition' no longer fit.

Grammar principle: by means of = using; in case of = if there is; in addition to = as well as.

Memory tip: method -> by means of; precaution -> in case of; extra -> in addition to.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Matching phrases in context

Q160. (Sentence correction)

Answer: 'Inspite of' should be 'In spite of'; 'according with' should be 'according to'. Corrected: 'In spite of the delay, and according to the notice, refunds will be given to all passengers.'

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Two separate phrase errors: the one-word spelling 'inspite', and 'according with' instead of 'according to'.

Grammar principle: in spite of (three words); according to (not 'according with').

Memory tip: In spite of + according to - fix both set phrases.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Correcting multiple phrase errors

Section H - Meaning Change Through Preposition Choice

Q161. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) to = he passed it for me to catch - I am the intended receiver (cooperative). (ii) at = he aimed it at me, usually to hit me (hostile/target). So 'to' = giving/passing; 'at' = aiming/attacking.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: treating at and to as interchangeable after throw.

Grammar principle: throw/pass to = the intended recipient; throw at = a target/aim (often hostile).

Memory tip: to = 'here, catch it'; at = 'take that!'.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** to (recipient) vs at (target)

Q162. (Multiple choice)

Answer: at

Explanation: hurl/throw at = aim to strike.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'to the guard' = passing it for him to catch. (c) 'for the guard' = on his behalf / intended for him. (d) 'toward the guard' = merely in his direction, not necessarily to hit.

Grammar principle: throw/hurl at = aim to strike (a target).

Memory tip: 'at' = aiming to hit.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Selecting 'at' for aiming

Q163. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) over = across the top of the town, crossing from one side to the other. (ii) above = at a higher level than the clouds (a vertical relationship, simply 'higher than'). So 'over' suggests crossing/covering; 'above' suggests only 'higher than'.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: assuming over and above are identical.

Grammar principle: over = across the top / crossing; above = at a higher level.

Memory tip: over = across it; above = higher than it.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** over vs above (meaning)

Q164. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) across = from one side of the field to the other, over its open surface. (ii) through = among whatever fills the field (tall crops, long grass), moving amid it. 'Across' focuses on reaching the other side; 'through' focuses on passing among things in it.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: treating across and through as the same for a field.

Grammar principle: across = over the surface, side to side; through = among what fills the space.

Memory tip: across = over the top; through = in among it.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** across vs through (field)

Q165. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: The difference is small. 'spoke with' slightly suggests a two-way conversation between equals; 'spoke to' can suggest a more one-directional exchange (you addressed them, perhaps to instruct). In most contexts they are interchangeable, with 'with' feeling a little more mutual.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: thinking one is wrong; both are correct.

Grammar principle: speak to = address someone; speak with = converse with (more mutual); largely interchangeable.

Memory tip: 'with' hints at a two-way chat; 'to' can be one-way.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** to vs with (nuance)

Q166. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) by = the agent/author who performed the writing (Gandhi). (ii) with = the instrument/tool used to write (a fountain pen). So 'by' names who did the action; 'with' names what was used to do it.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: confusing the agent (by) with the instrument (with).

Grammar principle: by + the doer (agent); with + the tool (instrument).

Memory tip: by = who did it; with = what they used.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** by (agent) vs with (instrument)

Q167. (Multiple choice)

Answer: with ... by

Explanation: carved with a chisel (the tool) by a local artist (the agent).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) reversed: 'carved by a chisel' wrongly makes the chisel the doer, and 'with a local artist' wrongly makes the artist a tool. (c)/(d) use one word for both, confusing tool and doer.

Grammar principle: with + instrument; by + agent.

Memory tip: with the tool, by the person.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** instrument (with) vs agent (by)

Q168. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) by = right beside / immediately next to the window. (ii) near = close to it but not necessarily right beside it - a little further away. So 'by' means directly alongside; 'near' means in the general area.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: treating by and near as identical distances.

Grammar principle: by = immediately beside; near = in the vicinity (looser).

Memory tip: by = right at it; near = around there.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** by vs near (distance)

Q169. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) run into (someone) = meet by chance / unexpectedly (an idiom). (ii) run to (someone) = physically move quickly towards them, on purpose. So 'ran into' = happened to meet; 'ran to' = deliberately went over to them.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: reading 'ran into' literally as a collision, or missing the idiom.

Grammar principle: run into someone = meet unexpectedly (idiom); run to someone = move quickly towards them.

Memory tip: 'ran into' = bumped into by chance; 'ran to' = dashed over on purpose.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** run into (idiom) vs run to

Q170. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: The difference is slight. 'a book on science' often suggests a more formal, academic or specialist treatment; 'a book about science' sounds a little more general or informal. In many cases they are interchangeable, with 'on' leaning scholarly and 'about' leaning general.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: assuming they are always identical or always different.

Grammar principle: on + subject (often scholarly/specialist); about + subject (often general); largely interchangeable.

Memory tip: 'on' feels like a textbook; 'about' feels like a general read.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** on vs about (topic nuance)

Q171. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) care about = be concerned about / consider important (their wellbeing matters to her). (ii) care for = look after / tend to them (provide care), and in some contexts 'be fond of'. So 'care about' = emotional concern; 'care for' = looking after.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: treating care about and care for as identical.

Grammar principle: care about = be concerned about; care for = look after (or, in negatives/questions, like).

Memory tip: care ABOUT = it matters to me; care FOR = I tend to / look after.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** care about vs care for

Q172. (Multiple choice)

Answer: for

Explanation: care for = look after / tend to.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'cares about' = is concerned about (not the physical looking-after sense). (c) 'cares of' is wrong. (d) 'cares with' is wrong.

Grammar principle: care for = look after.

Memory tip: care FOR = tend to.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Selecting 'for' for looking-after

Q173. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) dream of = long for / aspire to (a waking ambition). (ii) dream about = have a dream (while asleep) featuring something. So 'dream of' usually means a hope or ambition; 'dream about' usually means the images you saw while sleeping. (They can overlap, but this is the typical split.)

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: mixing the ambition sense with the sleeping-dream sense.

Grammar principle: dream of = aspire to; dream about = have a (sleeping) dream featuring.

Memory tip: dream OF = your ambition; dream ABOUT = last night's dream.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** dream of vs dream about

Q174. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) think of = have an opinion about (What is your opinion?). (ii) think about = consider / reflect on (spend time weighing it up). So 'think of' asks for an opinion; 'think about' means to ponder or consider.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: treating think of and think about as identical.

Grammar principle: think of = have an opinion (or bring to mind); think about = consider / ponder.

Memory tip: think OF = your verdict; think ABOUT = mull it over.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** think of vs think about

Q175. (Compare three sentences)

Answer: (i) hear = perceive a sound / receive information (the news reached you). (ii) hear of = know that something or someone exists (be aware of the band). (iii) hear from = receive a message or contact from someone (your sister contacted you). The particle changes the meaning from 'perceive' to 'know of the existence' to 'be contacted by'.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: mixing 'hear of' (know it exists) with 'hear from' (be contacted).

Grammar principle: hear = perceive; hear of = know of the existence; hear from = be contacted by.

Memory tip: hear it; hear OF it (know it exists); hear FROM someone (they contact you).

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** hear / hear of / hear from

Q176. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) result in = lead to / cause (the flood is the cause, the damage the effect). (ii) result from = be caused by (the damage is the effect, the flood the cause). The two reverse the cause-effect order: 'result in' points to the effect; 'result from' points to the cause.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: swapping the direction of cause and effect.

Grammar principle: X results in Y = X causes Y; Y results from X = Y is caused by X.

Memory tip: result IN the effect; result FROM the cause.

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** result in vs result from (cause-effect direction)

Q177. (Multiple choice)

Answer: from

Explanation: 'the loss resulted from the delay' = the delay caused the loss (the loss is the effect, the delay the cause).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'resulted in the delay' would mean the loss caused the delay (reversed). (c) 'resulted of' is wrong. (d) 'resulted to' is wrong.

Grammar principle: the effect + results from + the cause.

Memory tip: The effect results FROM the cause.

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Applying result from

Q178. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) talk to = address them in a normal, two-way or considerate way. (ii) talk at = speak in their direction without engaging or letting them respond (one-sided, often hectoring). So 'talk to' is communicative; 'talk at' ignores the listener.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: missing that 'at' here signals a lack of real engagement.

Grammar principle: talk to = communicate with; talk at = speak without engaging (one-sided).

Memory tip: talk TO = a real exchange; talk AT = you're just a wall they speak toward.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** talk to vs talk at

Q179. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) shout at = shout angrily/aggressively towards someone (hostile). (ii) shout to = call out loudly so they can hear (e.g. across a distance), not necessarily angry. So 'at' = angry; 'to' = calling to be heard.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: assuming both mean anger.

Grammar principle: shout at = angrily; shout to = to be heard across a distance.

Memory tip: shout AT = telling off; shout TO = calling out.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** shout at vs shout to

Q180. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) consist of = be made up of (parts or members). (ii) consist in = have its essential nature in / be based on (a more abstract, formal use). So 'consist of' lists the components; 'consist in' identifies what something essentially is.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: not knowing 'consist in' exists, or using 'consist of' where the meaning is 'lies in / is based on'.

Grammar principle: consist of = be composed of (parts); consist in = have its essence in.

Memory tip: consist OF = the ingredients; consist IN = the essence.

Difficulty: 9/10 | **Cognitive skill:** consist of vs consist in

Q181. (Multiple choice)

Answer: I heard from the author.

Explanation: hear from = receive contact / a message from someone.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (a) heard = perceived a sound. (b) heard of = know the author exists. (d) heard about = learned information concerning the author (from someone else), not direct contact.

Grammar principle: hear from = be contacted by (a direct message).

Memory tip: hear FROM = they reached out to you.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Applying hear from vs hear of/about

Section I - Abstract and Non-Physical Prepositions

Q182. (Multiple choice)

Answer: by ... by

Explanation: by + a means of transport (no article) states the general method: by train, by car, by bus, by plane (but 'on foot').

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b)/(c)/(d) mix 'on'/'in'. You may say 'in the car' or 'on the train' about a specific vehicle, but the general method is 'by car', 'by train'; both blanks want the general method.

Grammar principle: by + means of transport (no article) for the general method: by car/bus/train/plane; on foot.

Memory tip: How did you travel? -> by car/train/bus (but 'on foot').

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** by + transport (method)

Q183. (Multiple choice)

Answer: by ... with

Explanation: by + gerund states the method (by teaching); with + an instrument states the tool (with a red pen).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'with teaching' is wrong (method needs by + -ing), and 'by a red pen' wrongly makes the pen the doer. (c) 'by a red pen' makes the pen the doer. (d) 'with teaching' is wrong.

Grammar principle: by + gerund (method: by teaching); with + instrument (with a pen); never 'by a pen'.

Memory tip: You earn a living BY doing something; you write WITH a tool.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** by (method) vs with (instrument)

Q184. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: The traditional split is: 'die of' + an illness or internal condition (cancer, a fever, old age, hunger); 'die from' + an external cause or injury (wounds, a fall, exposure). In practice the two overlap and both are often accepted, but this is the usual guideline.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: using 'die by' for a disease - 'die by' is for a method of death ('die by drowning').

Grammar principle: die of + an illness/condition; die from + an injury/external cause; die by + a method.

Memory tip: of an illness, from a wound, by a method.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** die of / from / by

Q185. (Multiple choice)

Answer: for ... against

Explanation: vote for = in support of; vote against = in opposition to.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'voted to the trip' is wrong. (c) 'versus' is not used after 'voted' like this. (d) 'voted with' means 'voted the same way as (a person)', not 'in support of the trip'.

Grammar principle: for = in support of; against = in opposition to.

Memory tip: FOR = yes/support; AGAINST = no/oppose.

Difficulty: 5/10 | **Cognitive skill:** for vs against

Q186. (Multiple choice)

Answer: except ... besides

Explanation: except (the goalkeeper) = not including him; besides (training) = in addition to training.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) swapped: 'besides the goalkeeper' = in addition to him (but he is excluded); 'except training' = excluding training (but it is additional). (c) 'beside training' = physically next to training. (d) loses the 'excluding' meaning.

Grammar principle: except (for) = not including; besides = in addition to.

Memory tip: except = leave out; besides = add on.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** except vs besides (exclusion vs inclusion)

Q187. (Multiple choice)

Answer: from ... of

Explanation: made from real oranges (the source is transformed into juice); the smell of oranges (of = the characteristic quality belonging to oranges).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'made of oranges' understates the transformation (the juice no longer looks like oranges), and 'the smell from oranges' is less idiomatic than 'the smell of'. (c) 'the smell from oranges' is less idiomatic. (d) 'made of oranges' understates the transformation.

Grammar principle: made from (a transformed source); the smell/taste of X (a quality of X).

Memory tip: made FROM the source; the smell OF the thing.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** from (source) vs of (quality)

Q188. (Multiple choice)

Answer: between

Explanation: a connection/link/difference between X and Y - two items joined by 'and'.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'among' needs a group of three or more, not two named items joined by 'and'. (c) 'connection with smoking and lung disease' - the correct frame for two linked items is 'between ... and'. (d) 'connection of' is wrong.

Grammar principle: a connection/link/difference between X and Y (two items); connection with/to (a single other thing).

Memory tip: between two named things joined by 'and'.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** between X and Y (connection)

Q189. (Multiple choice)

Answer: on ... about

Explanation: a report on road safety ('report on' is the established phrase for a factual document); a story about a magic train (about = concerning).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'a report about' is weaker/informal, and 'a story on a magic train' is wrong. (c) 'a story on a magic train' is wrong. (d) 'a report about road safety' is weaker than the standard 'report on'.

Grammar principle: report on / lecture on / book on = the established topic phrase (esp. factual/academic); story/novel/film about = concerning.

Memory tip: Factual works are 'on' a topic; stories are 'about' something.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** on vs about (topic)

Q190. (Multiple choice)

Answer: through

Explanation: through + an intermediary = by means of / via someone acting as a channel (the friend helped you find it).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'by a friend' would suggest the friend did the finding (the agent). (c) 'from a friend' = the flat came from the friend (e.g. they gave it to you). (d) 'with a friend' = together with the friend.

Grammar principle: through + an intermediary/channel = by means of (via someone/something).

Memory tip: through a friend = your friend was the channel.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** through (via an intermediary)

Q191. (Multiple choice)

Answer: out of ... out of

Explanation: out of + a motive/feeling (honesty; fear) = because of that feeling.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'from honesty'/'of fear' - the motive phrase is 'out of'. (c) 'in fear' means 'in a state of fear', a different nuance, so mixing is inconsistent. (d) 'of honesty' is wrong.

Grammar principle: out of + a motive/feeling (out of kindness, fear, curiosity, respect) = because of it.

Memory tip: 'out of X' = driven by X (the motive).

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** out of (motive/reason)

Q192. (Multiple choice)

Answer: under ... under

Explanation: under + certain nouns = in the process of / subject to: under construction, under investigation.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'in construction' is wrong (it is 'under construction'). (c)/(d) mix 'on'/'in' where 'under' is required.

Grammar principle: under + certain nouns = in the process of: under construction, investigation, discussion, review, repair, control.

Memory tip: 'under construction' = being built; 'under investigation' = being looked into.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** under (process/subjection, abstract)

Q193. (Multiple choice)

Answer: beyond ... beyond

Explanation: beyond + an abstract limit = past what is possible: beyond my understanding, beyond belief.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'above my understanding' is sometimes heard, but 'beyond' is the standard idiom ('beyond me'); 'beyond belief' is fixed. (c)/(d) 'over/above belief' are wrong.

Grammar principle: beyond + an abstract limit: beyond belief, beyond repair, beyond doubt, beyond my understanding.

Memory tip: 'beyond belief' = too much to believe.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** beyond (past a limit, abstract)

Q194. (Correct or leave as is)

Answer: Correct - no change needed. 'trembling with fear' (the emotion causing the physical reaction) and 'because of nervousness' (the reason) are both right.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: The trap is 'correcting' a sentence that is already right - for example changing 'with fear' to 'from/of fear', or 'because of' to 'due to' unnecessarily.

Grammar principle: with + an emotion causing a reaction (tremble with fear); because of + a reason.

Memory tip: You tremble WITH fear; you stop BECAUSE OF nervousness.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Recognising correct abstract uses

Q195. (Multiple choice)

Answer: with ... with

Explanation: with + an emotion = the emotion causing a physical reaction (shaking with anger, red with embarrassment).

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'shaking of anger' is wrong. (c) 'shaking from anger' is heard, but 'with' is the standard for an emotion-driven reaction. (d) 'shaking by anger' is wrong.

Grammar principle: with + emotion = the emotion causing a physical state (tremble with fear, shake with anger, red with embarrassment).

Memory tip: shaking WITH anger = anger makes you shake.

Difficulty: 7/10 | **Cognitive skill:** with (emotion as cause)

Q196. (Multiple choice)

Answer: for ... against

Explanation: for her health = purpose/benefit; against injury = protection/guarding from.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'a helmet for injury' would wrongly suggest the helmet is meant to cause injury; protection takes 'against'. (c) 'to her health' is wrong. (d) 'vitamins against her health' reverses the sense.

Grammar principle: for = purpose/benefit; against = protection / guarding from.

Memory tip: FOR a benefit; AGAINST a danger.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** for (purpose) vs against (protection)

Q197. (Compare the two sentences)

Answer: (i) afraid of = frightened by the dog (the dog is the threat to me). (ii) afraid for = worried about the dog's safety (the dog is in danger and I fear on its behalf). So 'of' = the source of my fear; 'for' = the one I fear on behalf of.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: Error: treating of and for as identical after afraid.

Grammar principle: afraid of = scared by something; afraid for = worried about someone's safety.

Memory tip: afraid OF the threat; afraid FOR the one at risk.

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** afraid of vs afraid for

Q198. (Multiple choice)

Answer: in ... in ... in

Explanation: in + an abstract state/condition: in chaos, in silence, in ruins.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b)/(c)/(d) mix 'on'/'at', which are wrong for these fixed 'in + state' phrases.

Grammar principle: in + a state/condition: in chaos, in silence, in ruins, in danger, in love, in trouble, in doubt.

Memory tip: A state or condition takes 'in'.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** in (abstract state)

Q199. (Multiple choice)

Answer: at ... at

Explanation: at + a trigger of an emotional reaction (thrilled at, alarmed at); 'by' is also acceptable, but 'on' is not.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b)/(c)/(d) use 'on'/'with' where 'at' expresses the reaction; 'thrilled on' and 'alarmed on' are wrong.

Grammar principle: at (or by) + a trigger of a reaction: surprised/shocked/alarmed/delighted/thrilled at.

Memory tip: You react AT (or by) a piece of news.

Difficulty: 6/10 | **Cognitive skill:** at (reaction to a trigger)

Q200. (Multiple choice)

Answer: during ... in ... in

Explanation: during the crisis (throughout the event); in the interest of everyone (fixed phrase); in control = remained in charge.

Why the other options are wrong / common errors: (b) 'in the crisis' is weaker, 'on the interest' is wrong, and 'stayed under control' would mean she was being kept in check (wrong - she stayed in charge). (c) 'on the interest' is wrong. (d) 'at the crisis' is wrong.

Grammar principle: during + an event; in the interest(s) of (fixed); in control = in charge (vs under control = being managed).

Memory tip: during the crisis; in everyone's interest; she stayed in control (in charge).

Difficulty: 8/10 | **Cognitive skill:** Combining abstract prepositions